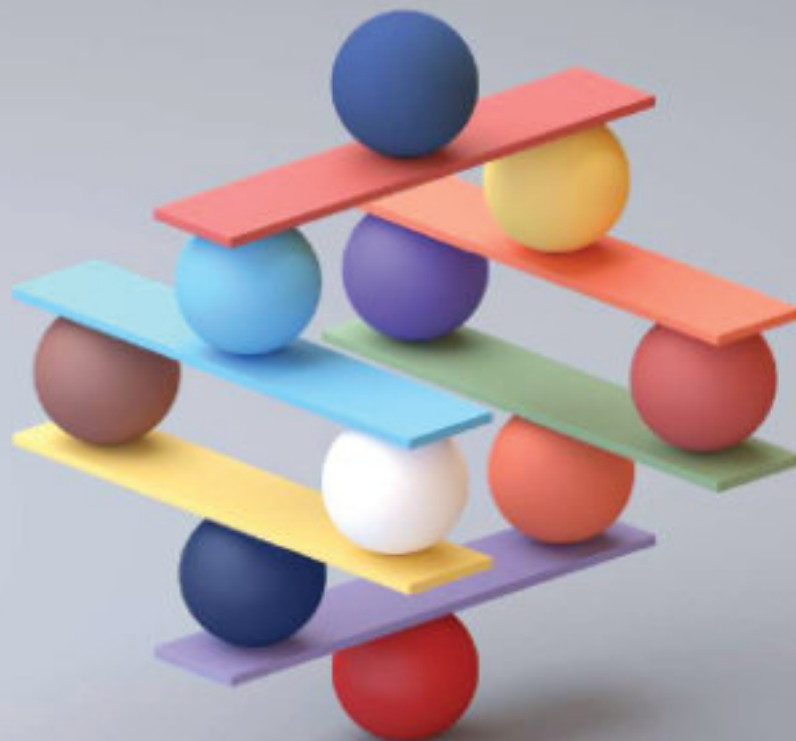




ANNUAL REPORT 24-25



LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

AICS | Italian Agency for Development Cooperation
CCI | Culture and Creativity Industries
CEI | Central European Initiative
CEKOM | Center kompetencija za istraživanje i razvoj
CSO | Depending on the context: Council of Senior Officials or Civil Society Organisation
DIHA | German Association of Industries and Trade in Albania
EBRD | European Bank for Reconstruction and Development
IVF | International Visegrad Fund
KCSS | Kosovar Center for Security Studies
KIESA | Kosovo* Investment and Enterprise Support Agency
MFA | Ministry of Foreign Affairs
MoFA Japan | Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Japan
MOVE | Specific name of one of the WBF Grant Schemes
NALAS | Network of Associations of Local Authorities of Southeastern Europe
NGO | Non-Governmental Organisation
OECD | Organisation for Economic Co-Operation and Development
OGMS | Online Grant Management System of the WBF
OSCE | Organisation for Security and Co-Operation in Europe
RAI | Regional Anti-Corruption Agency
ReSPA | Regional School of Public Administration
RNDS | Regional Networking and Dialogue Sessions
RYCO | Regional Youth Cooperation Office
SDC | Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation
SDP | Strategic Development Plan
UNESCO | United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organisation
USAID | United States Agency for International Development
WB | Western Balkans
WB6 | Western Balkans Six
WBF | Western Balkans Fund



* This designation is without prejudice to positions on status, and is in line with UNSCR 1244/1999 and the ICJ Opinion on the Kosovo declaration of independence.

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CHAPTER 1

THE FUND

- Foreword
- Measuring Impact
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- Catalogue of Key Events
- Expanding & Strengthening current Partnerships

FOREWORD

Dear Partners and Friends of the Western Balkans Fund

We are happy to present to you the Seventh Annual Report in WBF history, covering the period of events from June 2024 to July 2025. This year, continuing to be guided by our vision and mission, we actively expanded our partnerships and actions in the Western Balkans.

At the cornerstone of our success remains the diversification of our grant schemes which has proven to be an integral part of those efforts. We are pleased to see that in this period, we have supported financially more Civil Society Organisations (CSO), individuals, researchers and scholars than ever before. Starting the reporting year with just two active grant schemes, we end up with five.

In addition to the support dedicated to the Civil Society actors around the region, the Fund has developed a concrete vision for the 25-29 period. Part of this vision is to further increase our presence and leveraging our influence to become a key hub for Civil Society Organisations and all the region's cooperation activities in general.



On behalf of the entire team at the Western Balkans Fund, allow me to extend our warmest gratitude:

- * To the Ministries of Foreign Affairs of the Region, who guide and support the Fund.
- * To the international partners such as the European Union, Japan, Switzerland, Italy, and other many other regional partners who keep sharing the same vision for our beautiful region.
- * To the WBF grantees, applicants, and all our beneficiaries, who give meaning to every action we support.

More than ever, the Western Balkans Fund is looking forward to growing its impact and building human bridges of cooperation together with many other stakeholders in the Region that share the same vision of ours.

Dr. Gjergj Murra, <
Executive Director of the Western Balkans Fund

An ambitious and achievable
vision of the future

The Western Balkans Fund envisions a region at peace with itself; prosperously integrated into its European home. It envisages a region where exchange and fruitful, mutually beneficial relations of cooperation between people at all levels and from all walks of life are the norm rather than the exception

The Fund's commitment is
exemplified by its programme mission

The Western Balkans Fund promotes the development of ever closer cooperation and the strengthening of ties between the Western Balkans Contracting Parties, the integration of the Contracting Parties into the European Union and a common presentation of the Fund's Contracting Parties both within and beyond the region. It supports the champions of regional cooperation through a diversified programme of grants, support for access to ongoing dialogue about regional cooperation, and the provision of technical assistance and capacity development to civil society partners.



MEASURING IMPACT

Assesing WBF Regional activities

Since the release of our 2024 Annual Report, the Western Balkans Fund continued to influence the region with a dynamic, impact-first approach. Driven by the 2020–2024 Strategic Development Plan and our vision of the “Theory of Change”, the Fund turned vision into results fueling collaboration through 112 new grants for Civil Society and individuals.

Data collected from the surveys and community dialogues revealed growing openness, reduced prejudice and deeper mutual understanding; also, the

shift of public attitudes toward regional cooperation and good neighborly relations indicate the increase of willingness to work in regional partnership. Additionally, participation rose across cultural, educational and grassroots events providing a clear sign of the region coming together.

Our vision for the future spotlights key objectives for 2025–2029, as the Fund scales what works, adapt where needed, and keep building bridges across the region.

What is Theory of change

The Western Balkans Fund Theory of Change emphasizes that through direct support to regional projects, it can improve good neighbourly relations that can transcend geographical and cultural boundaries. This investment is yet more compelling because the funding is provided by the Contracting Parties themselves, thus demonstrating a clear commitment at the highest political level.

Awarding Ceremony of the ERC Grant Scheme



Monitoring and Learning (MEL) remains a cornerstone of WBF's operations, enabling the Fund to measure impact, enhance decision making, and improve future calls for proposals. In 2024–2025, WBF implemented two major funding schemes—the 6th Call for Proposals (CfP) and Empowering Regional Cooperation (ERC) Grants – generating valuable data and lessons.

1. Strengthened regional networks

 - Over 1,100 organizations engaged across calls, mentoring, and networking events.
 - Average number of diversified partnerships has been increased with reported increased transfer of knowledge and skills among partners within same partnership consortia.
2. Inclusion of new and grassroots actors

 - Around 67% of lead applicants in all three calls were new applicants to WBF. Implying that WBF still attracts different and diversified actors in regional arena.
 - Around 40% applicants throughout the calls identified as grassroots organizations, confirming WBF's accessibility to emerging actors.
3. Capacity development and knowledge transfer

 - Info sessions, mentoring, and RNDS events reached over 500 participants, with very high satisfaction levels (4.8/5).
 - Smaller CSOs gained skills in project design, financial management, and partnership-building, contributing to more competitive proposals in future calls.
4. Gender equality and diversity

 - Balanced gender leadership in ERC projects and 57% female participation in events.
 - WBF's gender-responsive approach strengthened inclusivity and ensured representation of women in decision-making roles.
5. Increased Visibility

 - Over 40 media items (TV, podcasts, articles) and strong social media presence amplified the visibility of WBF grantees and their successful stories and activities. This impacted their visibility to local stakeholders, other partners and enhanced local ownership of the project outcomes affecting long-lasting sustainability.
 - The Partnership Platform (Facebook) attracted over 2,500 users, laying groundwork for a permanent digital hub for regional cooperation.
6. Policy-level contribution

 - Regional Networking and Dialogue Sessions (RNDS) discussions identified issues and actionable solutions, feeding into regional policy debates and future initiatives.

Lessons Learned

IMPORTANCE OF PARTNERSHIPS

Enforcing partnership component encouraged diversity, but future calls should incorporate additional support for forming sustainable consortia.

TECHNICAL QUALITY

While the number of applicants grows, AI-assisted proposals pose an additional and growing challenge, because of the non-harmonious and synthetic project proposals that are submitted when AI is used extensively.

FINANCIAL ENVELOPE

The financial need for supporting project proposals highlights the strong demand for WBF support and the need for expanded funding.

DEMAND FOR CAPACITY BUILDING ACTIVITIES

Continuous mentoring and targeted training and mentoring significantly improve application proposals and implementation quality, especially for smaller organizations.

Do you know:

With 373 organizations and individuals supported, the Western Balkans Fund has awarded, on average, more than one grant for every day of the past reporting year.

During this period, WBF effectively delivered a diverse portfolio of grant mechanisms, including:

- 6th Call for Proposals
- ERC Grant Scheme (co-funded by the European Union)
- 7th Call for Proposals (co-funded by the European Union)
- Western Balkans – Visegrad Fellowship 2nd Call for Applicants
- WBF Move Grant (5th Call for Proposals)

Grants since June 2024'



6th Call for Proposals

24 lead
56 partners

Western Balkans Visegrad Fellowship (1st Call)

41 winners

ERC

12 lead
49 partners

Western Balkans – Visegrad Fellowship (2nd Call)

44 winners

7th Call for Proposals

30 lead
88 partners

WBF Move Grant (5th Call)

29 winners





Staff of the WBF, during a meeting dedicated to the enhancement of the WBF systems

WBF is prioritizing several key institutional improvements:

- Strengthening program impact through data-driven planning and results-based monitoring.
- Expanding the mentoring component to enhance project implementation quality.
- Modernizing internal systems to improve efficiency and delivery service.
- Enhancing visibility through advocacy and structured dialogue platforms.
- Internal reforms focused on human resources development and digital transformation, ensuring alignment with core values of excellence, transparency and accountability.
- Making significant progress toward its strategic goals and to consolidate its position as a leading institution in advancing inclusive and sustainable regional cooperation across the Western Balkans.



The landing page of the currently under development WBF Partnership Hub

Reaffirming the regional ownership From Sarajevo 2024 to Prishtina 2025



December 2024

The Chairmanship in Office of the Western Balkans Fund officially passess from Sarajevo to Prishtina. In the picture, the representatives of the respective Ministries of Foreign Affairs, Mr. Behmenn (l) and Mr. Tora (r).

In 2024, the Chairmanship-in-Office of the Western Balkans Fund passed from Tirana to Sarajevo. Under the leadership of MFA Sarajevo, the Chairmanship focused on three core priorities.

First, it worked hard to enhance the regional and international visibility of the Fund. Thanks to those efforts, WBF reached record-high numbers both in terms of visibility and in applications received. For the first time, the reach of WBF across all communication channels combined surpassed 1 million citizens. A celebration of the Chairmanship at MFA Sarajevo, with ambassadors, media, partners, and other regional stakeholders, made a great contribution in that regard. Also of great importance was the organized visit of representatives from all MFAs to Brussels to put forward the case for stronger backing by the European Union.

A second priority for Sarajevo was fundraising and the mobilization of additional resources. In this field as well, WBF made important progress, signing new cooperation agreements with new partners and further diversifying its financial envelope.

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Celebrating the Chairmanship in Office of the Prishtina 2025 - June 2025

And third, great attention was paid to strengthening the internal capacities of the Secretariat.

Since January 2025, the Chairmanship-in-Office of the Fund has rotated to MFA Prishtina. Building on Sarajevo's momentum, the Prishtina CiO assumed office with a forward-leaning agenda aimed at deepening WBF's impact and outreach.

Already by mid-January, the new Chairmanship had supported the successful launch of a new Call for Proposals. The increase of grant schemes to a total of five is taking place under Prishtina's tenure. Great attention has also been paid to further increasing the stature and visibility of the Fund, overhauling communication efforts.

The Prishtina CiO has also initiated renewed efforts to expand the Fund's partnerships and reinforce key schemes for support and capacity building. These initiatives are ongoing, and their full impact will be assessed in the next reporting cycle.

Do you know that

According to WBF Statute, the Conference of the Ministers of Foreign Affairs is the supreme body of the Western Balkans Fund.

Contracting Parties appoint plenipotentiaries at the Council of the Senior Officials, a body which is reunited at least once in six months (but in practice 3-4 times per year) to steer the work of the Secretariat.



ED Murra at the SEECP Ministerial in Tirana



With the Minister of Foreign Affairs of North Macedonia, H.E. Mucunski



Conference of Foreign Ministers



2017, Conference of the Foreign Ministers



Meeting with the Minister of Foreign Affairs of Bosnia and Herzegovina, H.E. Elmedin Konakovic



Establishment of the Fund back in 2017, Dr. Murra with Minister Bushati



With the Minister of Foreign Affairs of Serbia, H.E. Djuric



Minister Hasani visiting the Secretariat



Awarding the Minister of Foreign Affairs of the Czech Republic, H.E. Lipavsky

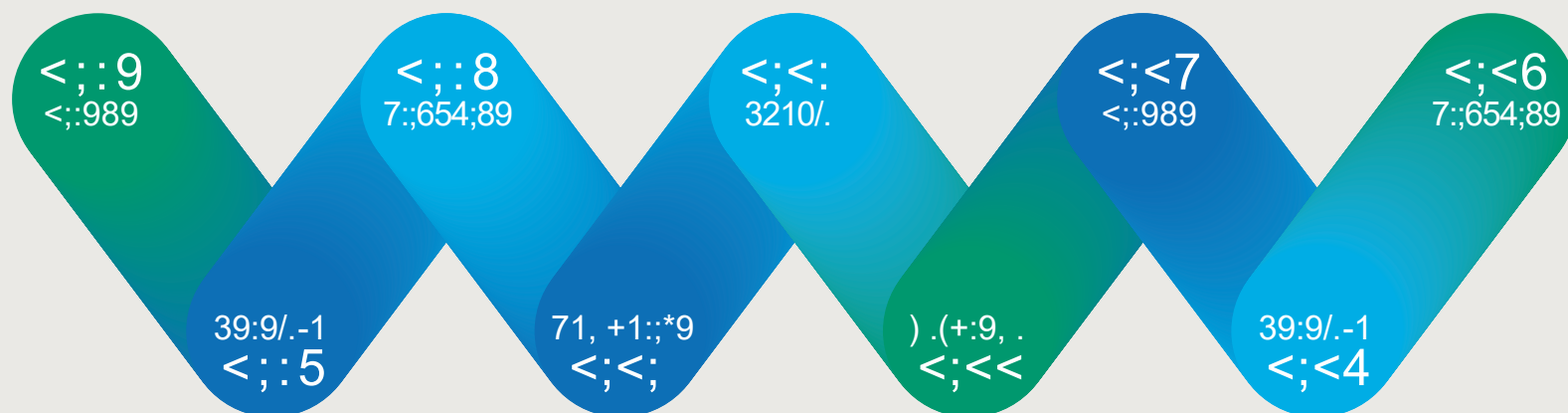


2019, with Minister Pacolli

Do you know?!

The Chairmanship-in-Office of the Western Balkans Fund rotates in a yearly pre-established order.

Previous Chairmanship-in-Office of the Fund have been:



In the next year, the Chairmanship-in-Office of the Fund will rotate again for the second time to the Podgorica 2026 CiO

WBF Council of Senior Officials: steering regional cooperation forward



CSO Meetings

Chaired by the Sarajevo 2024 Chairmanship-in-Office, the September 2024 meeting of the Council of Senior Officials represented a pivotal moment in the Fund's strategic development. Building on the outcomes of the previous session held in Brussels, the Council engaged in substantive dialogue and adopted key decisions that guide the Fund's programming and organizational growth in the months ahead. The meeting reinforced WBF's commitment to structured consultation, joint ownership, and continued collaboration among Contracting Parties core principles highlighting the Fund's role as a regional platform for cooperation and integration.

September 2024

In December 2024, the Council of Senior Officials of the Western Balkans Fund held its final meeting of the year, providing a valuable opportunity for reflection, consolidation, and forward planning. The Council reviewed key milestones from the final trimester, including the successful implementation of regional cooperation projects and the Fund's growing visibility across the Western Balkans. A central item on the agenda was the adoption of the 2025 budget and discussion of strategic priorities for the upcoming year. The meeting also marked a formal transition in leadership, with the Chairmanship-in-Office passing from Sarajevo to Prishtina 2025, setting the stage for a new cycle of institutional growth and regional engagement.

December 2024

On 22–23 April 2025, the Council of Senior Officials of the Western Balkans Fund convened under the leadership of the Prishtina 2025 Chairmanship-in-Office for a key coordination meeting. High-level representatives appointed by the six Ministries of Foreign Affairs of the Western Balkans reviewed the progress of the Secretariat's activities and endorsed a strategic roadmap for the upcoming quarter. The Council engaged in focused discussions on ongoing initiatives, emphasizing the importance of maximizing impact and strengthening regional coherence. Strategic decisions taken during the meeting prioritized the expansion of funding opportunities and reaffirmed the Fund's growing role as a driver of regional cooperation and integration across the Western Balkans.

April 2025

Enhancing Partnerships

With like-minded organisations and strategic partners continue to grow

One of the biggest achievements of the Western Balkans Fund is the ability not only to expand partnerships, but also to retain them. Throughout WBF's lifetime, we have developed strong relations with all our major donors, and those relations have endured and, in most cases, expanded over time.



EUROPEAN UNION

One crucial example is the relationship of the Fund with the European Union. The WBF and EU signed a cooperation agreement in mid-2021, giving birth to the “Support to the Promotion of Civil Society Regional Actions in the Western Balkans” project. Through the financial support provided in 2021–24, the EU co-funded the 4th and 5th Calls for Proposals. In January 2024, upon the termination of the first 30-month-long project, the EU renewed its support for a subsequent 24 months.



Ambassador of EU Delegation to Tirana, H.E. Silvio Gonzato, at the Awarding Ceremony of the ERC Grant Scheme



SWISSGOVERNMENT

Another crucial partner of the Fund is the Swiss Government, which has been supporting the institutional strengthening of the Western Balkans Fund since 2021. Part of this support is the flagship WBF Move Grant, which has been co-funded in the 5th Call for Proposals. Furthermore, Switzerland's support has been crucial in enhancing Secretariat capacities, advancing fundamental strategic targets, and ensuring transparency and accountability. The talks to extend cooperation in the 2026-29 are currently in an advance phase.



Ambassador of SwissConfederation, H.E. Ruth Huber (right), at a WBF-organised conference



Ambassador of Japan to Tirana, H.E. Kikuko Kato, at SYNERGY Opening Ceremony

JAPANESE GOVERNMENT

The Government of Japan, through its Embassy in Tirana, has maintained a six-year cooperation with the Fund, resulting in the organization of six major events, such as the most recent Synergy Conference. These large-scale advocacy events have, over the years, focused on critical topics for the future of the Western Balkans Region, such as the fight against misinformation and fake news, gender equality, regional cohesion, women's empowerment, and the importance of deeper cooperation between CSOs in our Region.



Executive Director of the International Visegrad Fund, Ms. Helbichova



INTERNATIONAL VISEGRAD FUND (IVF)

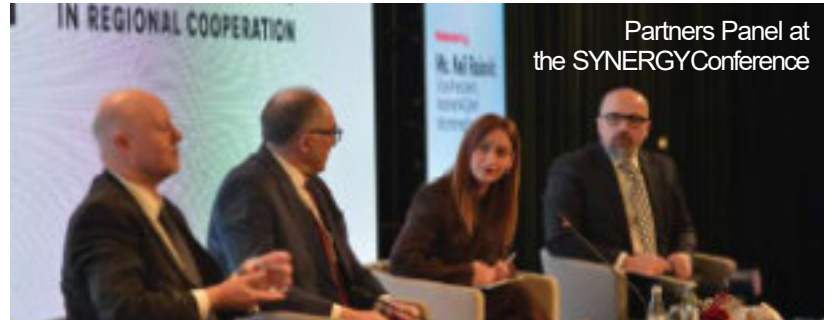
The International Visegrad Fund is the very first and one of the most important strategic partners for the WBF. Cooperation with IVF began immediately after the establishment of the Fund on 5 September 2017, and to a large extent, the Secretariat was structured to resemble the operational model of the IVF. Besides supporting WBF at every step, since 2024, together with IVF, the Fund has initiated a tailor-made program of cooperation between scholars and researchers in our two regions.



ED Murra shakes hands with the head of AICS for Western Balkans, Ms. Vizzaccaro

ITALIAN AGENCY FOR COOPERATION AND DEVELOPMENT (AICS)

The cooperation between the Fund and AICS began in 2024, when both parties agreed to implement a regional project aimed at increasing the capacities and fundraising potential of Culture and Creative Industry (CCI) stakeholders in the Region. Through this cooperation, WBF initiated a regional "offensive," creating new networks of cooperation and supporting the expansion of funding opportunities for the CCI sector in the Region.



Partners Panel at the SYNERGY Conference

CEI - RESPA - RYCO - RAI - RCC

The Western Balkans Fund has established extensive cooperation with like-minded partners and organizations that work across the Western Balkans Region. Because of overlapping interests and the nature of our work, we have often cooperated — and continue to strongly cooperate — with the Regional Cooperation Council (RCC) and RYCO. We have also extended cooperation with the Regional School of Public Administration (RESPA), the Regional Anti-Corruption Initiative (RAI), and the Central European Initiative (CEI), while remaining open and working constantly with a multitude of other regional and like-minded partners.



CHAPTER 2

WBF'S GRANT SCHEMES

- WBF grant schemes
- Mapping the WBF Interest
- Catalyzing regional cooperation: What we learned so far?
- Grant Recipients Catalogue
- ERCGrants Scheme
- 6th Call for Proposals
- 7th Call for Proposals
- WBF Move Grants
- WBF Fellowship Program



WBF's Direct Support to civil society, organizations & individuals

During the reporting period, the Western Balkans Fund successfully launched five Calls for Proposals across its four active Grant Schemes.



THE 6TH CALL FOR PROPOSALS

Fully financed through the WBF core budget, the 6th Call for Proposals was launched in November 2023. The implementation phase commenced in March 2024 and run until January 2025. The Call generated strong interest across the region, with 494 applications received. Of these, 279 project proposals met the eligibility criteria and advanced to further stages of evaluation.

ERC Grant Scheme

Co-funded by the European Union, the ERC Grant Scheme is the largest funding mechanism ever implemented by the Fund, offering grants ranging from €20,000 to €30,000. Launched on 9 May 2024 and opened through 20 June 2024, the Call attracted 277 applications from Civil Society Organizations across the Western Balkans. Of these, 142 proposals passed the automated eligibility check. The selected projects were awarded in September 2024, with implementation taking place between October 2024 and May 2025.

THE 7TH CALL FOR PROPOSALS

The 7th Call for Proposals, co-funded by the European Union under the second phase of the project “Support to the Promotion of Civil Society Regional Actions”, marked a significant milestone for the Western Balkans Fund. Launched on 13 January 2025, the Call attracted an unprecedented 744 applications, of which 416 were deemed eligible setting a new record for participation in the Fund’s history.

The Awarding Ceremony and official launch of the implementation phase were strategically scheduled to coincide with Europe Day, 8 May 2025, symbolizing the shared values of cooperation and unity. The implementation period is set to run until November 2025.

This Call reaffirms WBF’s role as a leading facilitator of regional cooperation and highlights the growing trust placed in the Fund by civil society actors across the Western Balkans.

THE 1ST CALL OF THE WESTERN BALKANS – VISEGRAD FELLOWSHIP

Launched in April 2024, the Western Balkans – Visegrad Fellowship was a pioneering initiative jointly implemented by the Western Balkans Fund and the International Visegrad Fund. Designed to promote academic exchange and regional research collaboration, the Fellowship supported PhD holders and PhD candidates from both the Western Balkans and the Visegrad Four countries (Poland, Czech Republic, Hungary, and Slovakia).

The first Call attracted 151 applications, resulting in the selection of 41 Fellows. Implementation began in September 2024 and ended up in May 2025.

As a pilot initiative, the Fellowship laid the groundwork for deeper academic cooperation between the two regions and reflects WBF’s expanding commitment to knowledge exchange, mobility, and long-term regional integration through educational excellence.

THE 2ND CALL OF THE WESTERN BALKANS – VISEGRAD FELLOWSHIP

Building on the success of the inaugural round, the Second Call of the Western Balkans – Visegrad Fellowship was launched in May 2025, continuing the strong partnership between the Western Balkans Fund and the International Visegrad Fund. The Fellowship remains dedicated to supporting PhD holders and PhD candidates from both the Western Balkans and the Visegrad Four countries.

At the end of the evaluation stage, 44 new fellows were awarded.

5TH CALL OF THE WBF MOVE GRANTS

The 5th Call for Proposals under the WBF MOVE Grants Scheme was launched in October 2024, aiming to enhance regional mobility and people-to-people exchange across the Western Balkans. A total of 28 individuals were supported through this round, enabling participation in educational, cultural, and professional activities that foster cross-border cooperation and mutual understanding.

The implementation phase began in January 2025 and successfully concluded in June 2025.

This Call was co-funded by the Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation (SDC), as part of its broader commitment to the institutional strengthening of the Western Balkans Fund.

6th Call for Proposals

297 lead applicants
963 total applicants
64.8% new applicants
4,352,400 EUR requested in total

ERC Grant Scheme

142 lead applicants
645 total applicants
56.3% new applicants
360.000 EUR Financial Envelope
5,063,720 EUR requested in total

7th Call for Proposals

417 lead applicants
1124 total applicants
63% new applicants
410.000 EUR Financial Envelope
7,339,617 EUR requested in total



6th call
24 winners/
279 applications

Supported since June 2024
66 Civil Society Organizations
70 Individuals

ERC
12 winners/
145 applications

Move Grant
29 winners/
144 applicants

Fellowship
41 winners/
151 applicants

7th call
30 winners/
416 applications

1.105
valid applications
registered during
this timeline

Mapping of the WBF interest

During the reporting period, we successfully identified 79 distinct locations from which inquiries and applications were submitted. This analysis is based on over 2,000 expressions of interest to participate in WBF events, as well as data gathered through applications submitted under our Call for Proposals. The findings reinforce the conclusion that interest in our activities is relatively evenly distributed between capital cities and provincial areas across our Contracting Parties.

Below is the complete list of cities from which expressions of interest have been detected.

ALBANIA

Berat
Durrës
Elbasan
Fier
Kavajë
Korçë
Kukës
Kamëz
Lezhë
Lushnjë
Pogradec
Sarandë
Shkodër
Tiranë
Vau Dejës
Vlorë

BOSNIA AND HERZEGOVINA

Banja Luka
Bihać
Bijeljina
Cazin
Doboj
Istočno Sarajevo (for East Sarajevo)
Gradiška
Mostar
Prijedor
Široki Brijeg
Sarajevo
Tuzla
Zenica

KOSOVO

Deçan
Ferizaj
Gjakovë
Gjilan
Mitrovicë
Pejë
Prishtinë
Prizren
Vushtri

MONTENEGRO

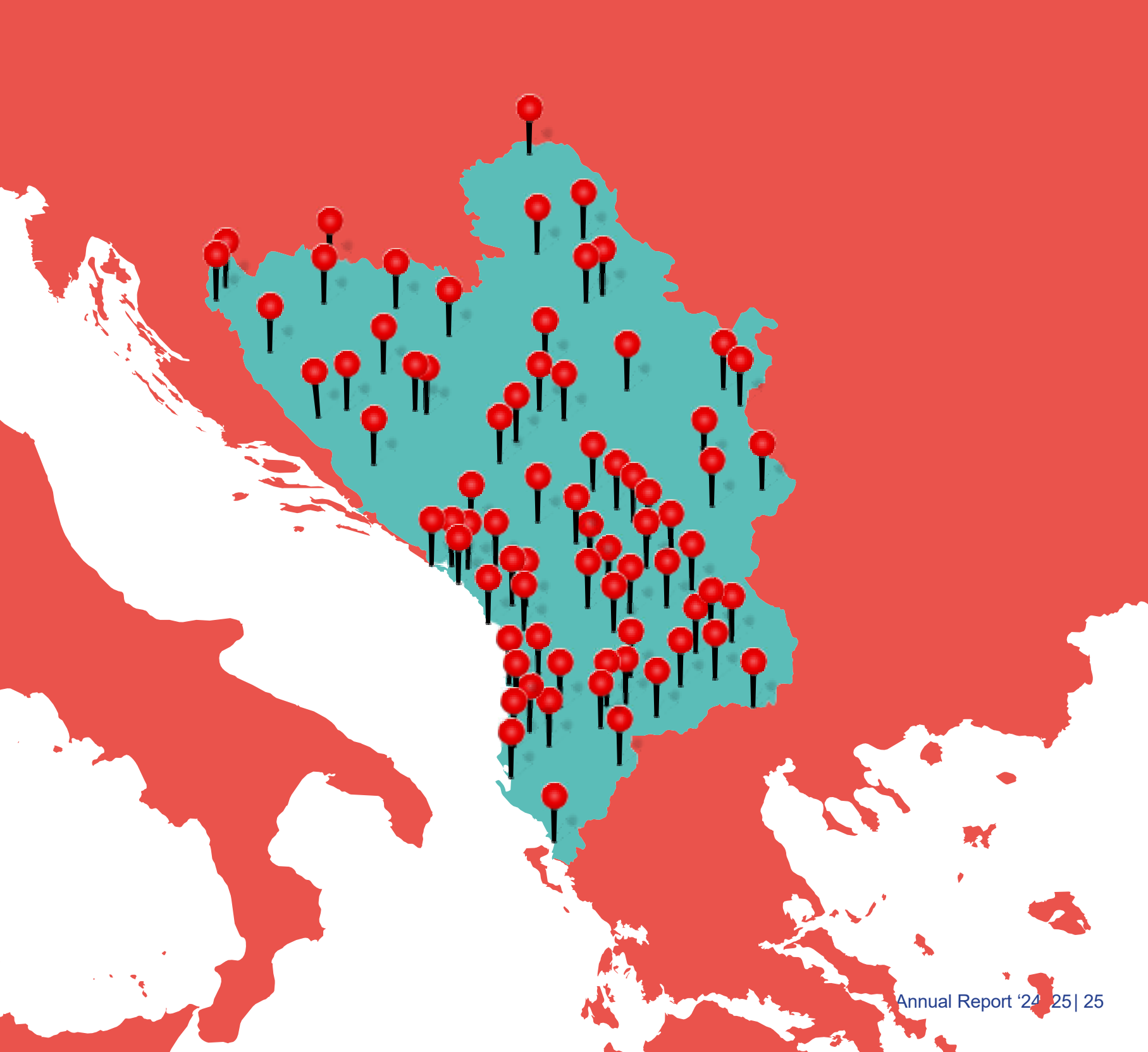
Bar
Berane
Budva
Cetinje
Herceg Novi
Kotor
Nikšić
Pljevlja
Podgorica
Tivat
Ulcinj

NORTH MACEDONIA

Bitola
Debar
Gevgelija
Gostivar
Kavadarci
Kičevo
Kumanovo
Ohrid
Prilep
Skopje
Struga
Sveti Nikole
Tetovo
Veles
Štip

SERBIA

Bitola
Debar
Gevgelija
Gostivar
Kavadarci
Kičevo
Kumanovo
Ohrid
Prilep
Skopje
Struga
Sveti Nikole
Tetovo
Veles
Štip



GRANT RECIPIENTS CATALOGUE





WBF 6th
Call for
Proposals

Belgrade International Law Circle

Partners

- Humanistic Studies of the University of Donja Gorica | Podgorica
- Faculty of Political Sciences University of Sarajevo | Sarajevo

Empowering Journalism Educators in the Western Balkans for Conflict & Crisis Reporting

This project successfully impacted the quality of reporting and supported the regional integration of journalists on crisis and conflict reporting in the Western Balkans. It delivered a model syllabus based on the principles of the international humanitarian law and journalistic ethics, alongside an innovative Crisis Reporting Toolkit distributed across academic and professional networks.

51
students and
professors
benefited directly
from this project

One of the workshops held during the project implementation



91%
satisfaction rate



6th
Call for
Proposals

Vision for Development and Cooperation | Presevo

Partners

- Inkubatori I Biznesit | Gjilan
- NGO "Zgjate Doren" | Tetovo
- Municipality of Lushnje | Lushnje

Empowering Rural Youth Organizations

The project empowered youth workers from Serbia, Kosovo, Albania, and North Macedonia with practical skills in project management, fundraising, and advocacy. Using creative and digital storytelling, it strengthened their ability to design impactful community programs. It also enabled cross-border networking, resulting in new partnerships and enhanced regional cooperation among rural youth organizations in the Western Balkans.

Participants of the Empowering Rural Youth Organisations receive their certificates of appreciation in Presevo





6th Call for Proposals

VAM CENTAR | Belgrade

Partners

- National Gallery of Bosnia and Herzegovina | Sarajevo
- Museum of Polimlje | Berane

Serbia, Bosnia and Herzegovina and Montenegro connected by cultural heritage and art

The project, based on the work of Yugoslav architect Bogdan Bogdanović, successfully promoted regional cooperation, reconciliation, and people-to-people connections by reactivating his monuments across all former Yugoslav republics. Through nine public events, including major roundtables in Sarajevo and Mostar, the project fostered dialogue around shared heritage and post-war memory. It maintained continuous regional engagement through frequent in-person and online meetings among experts and reached over 1,700 children with free creative workshops and art materials.

1700

Children were included directly as beneficiaries of this project

In Sarajevo, one of the workshops involving children



6th Call for Proposals

Serbian Association of Employers | Belgrade

Partners

- Business Confederation of Macedonia | Skopje
- Montenegro Employers Federation | Podgorica

Ecological Business Sustainability

The project helped stakeholders better understand their shared challenges and goals, creating space for direct communication at both national and regional levels. It encouraged partner organizations to connect with new stakeholders and strengthen existing relationships, leading to the signing of open-ended cooperation agreements focused on improving education and workforce development across the Western Balkans. In-person events brought together a wide range of participants and fostered open, practical dialogue.

600

people in the Contracting Parties benefited from this project

450

under 30
450
women

From the project visit in a Ruma highschool in Serbia





6th Call for Proposals

NGO GREENHOME | Podgorica

Partners

- Environmentally Responsible Action (ERA)| Pejë
- Institute for Nature Conservation in Albania | Tiranë

Ecological Business Sustainability

The project raised awareness among students in Montenegro, Albania, and Kosovo about the importance of cross-border cooperation in the Accursed Mountains. Through info days, social media, and a five-day regional summer camp, students gained practical knowledge on nature protection, explored the biodiversity and cultural heritage of Prokletije, and formed connections across borders. The camp encouraged future collaboration, environmental responsibility, and joint initiatives among young participants.

20
students
participated in the
5-day outdoor camp
organized as part of
this project

Participants of the outdoor events in Prokletije



6th Call for Proposals

Culture Center “Stara Budva” | Budva

Partners

- Ansambl za narodni pesni i ora “Skopje” | Skopje
- Kulturno umjetničko društvo Abrašević | Kraljevo
- Kulturno umjetničko društvo “Željezara” | Zenica

Culture makes us unique

In the framework of “Culture makes us unique” project, Budva hosted a 4-day folkloric festival, turning the city into a vibrant regional hub of cultural exchange. Over 200 young participants from Montenegro, Bosnia and Herzegovina, North Macedonia, Serbia, and guests from Ukraine shared traditions through music, dance, and costume. The project created strong friendships, cultural understanding, and respect among youth aged 13–35, many of whom visited Budva for the first time. A highlight was the May 25 performance in Budva’s Old Town, celebrating regional diversity and promoting tolerance.

200+
participants
benefited directly,
while the festival
was attended by
2.000+ citizens

Dancers wearing traditional
costumes in Budva





6th
Call for
Proposals



6th
Call for
Proposals

Faculty of Montenegrin Language

Partners

- Regional Academy for Democratic Development ADD | Novi Sad
- Faculty of Political Science, University of Sarajevo | Sarajevo

Soft and Hard Power Dynamic: WB Perspectives on Democracy, Education & Security

The project made a meaningful impact on regional cooperation, people-to-people links, and reconciliation in the Western Balkans through the successful organization of the Cetinje Forum and the launch of the Think Tank WestBalkanNet. The Forum brought together representatives from academia, civil society, and institutions across the region for inclusive, in-depth dialogue on pressing socio-political issues, challenging stereotypes and fostering mutual understanding.

H.E. Vesna Pusic during the workshop in Cetinje



KK Olymp | Niksic

Partners

- Basketball club Vojvodina | Novi Sad
- Basketball club Buducnost | Bjeljina

Western Balkans Girls U13 Basketball Cup

This project helped in regional cooperation and advancing gender equality in sports through the successful organization of the Western Balkan Girls U13 Basketball Cup. Bringing together six teams from four Contracting Parties, the tournament fostered cross-border connections, encouraged youth engagement, and highlighted the importance of female participation in sports. It created a platform for cultural exchange, mutual respect, and future collaboration in the region.

100
young girls up to 14
years old coming
from 4 different
Contracting Parties

6 basketball team together during
the event held in Niksic





6th Call for Proposals



6th Call for Proposals

Rona Nishliu Foundation

Partners

- NGO: Umjetnost džez-JazzArt | Podgorica
- CENTRE Albanian Jazz Society | Tiranë

WB6 Young Jazz Musicians at Mitrovica International Jazz Days | Mitrovica

The Mitrovica International Jazz Days (MIJD) 2024, through the WB6 Musicians Workshop, made a strong impact on regional cooperation, people-to-people ties, and reconciliation in the Western Balkans. By uniting musicians from Kosovo, Serbia, Albania, Bosnia and Herzegovina, and North Macedonia, the project fostered cross-border collaboration and creative exchange through joint compositions and performances. In a region shaped by past conflict, music served as a bridge for dialogue and understanding. The resulting album and future joint projects ensure the initiative's sustainability, while also drawing increased support from local stakeholders and donors.

Mitrovica Jazz Festival occupied a central stage in Mitrovica for three days



Chamber of Nurses of Kosovo | Prishtina

Partners

- The order of the nurse of Albania | Tirana
- Association of Albanian Nurses, Florence Nightingale | Tetovo

Second International Congress of Nursery

The project strengthened regional cooperation and people-to-people ties by bringing together health professionals from across the Balkans and Europe to share experiences, research, and best practices. With over 130 scientific papers presented, the congress created a network that highlighted shared healthcare challenges and encouraged dialogue across national and professional boundaries. These interactions enhance mutual understanding, break down barriers, and build trust.

Main event of Chamber of Nurses of Kosovo attracted over 100 young doctors and nurses from the Region

130
scientific papers
from all the Region
were supported by
this project





6th Call for Proposals



6th Call for Proposals

Center Multimedia | Prishtinë

Partners

- Center for Balkan Cooperation LOJA | Tetovo
- Qendra “Kujri” dhe Grupi “Ata” | Kamëz

LITERACYFESTIVAL: POLIP 2024 – Creative writing workshop

The project brought together young and aspiring writers from Western Balkans for a creative writing workshop held in Prishtina, led by Pulitzer Prize-winning author Gregory Pardlo. Aiming to nurture literary talent and foster cross-cultural exchange, the initiative offered an inclusive space for participants to develop their skills and share their voices. The workshop culminated in public presentations at the POLIPliterary festival, followed by the publication of a multilingual booklet featuring the writers' work in both their original languages and English.



Gregory Pardlo, winner of Pulitzer Prize for Poetry in 2015, one of the trainers of the Writing Academy

Past workshops of Polip Fest



Education Empowerment Initiative | Prishtinë

Partners

- Center for Excellence Destiny | Tiranë
- Women in Science Network | Tetovo

MediaWISE – Digital media education as an important indicator of pupils' health and well-being

The project explored the level of addiction of young teenagers of 12-14 years old to social media. It investigated the challenges and risks that addiction can pose. In doing so, it significantly advanced regional cooperation and people-to-people connections by uniting stakeholders from multiple Contracting Parties around the shared goal of improving children's digital safety and education. The Regional Conference in Prishtina served as a key moment of collaboration, drawing strong participation from high-level officials and educators across the region.

Presenting the findings of the project in a large conference in Prishtina



924

beneficiaries
among the
students of the
participating
schools



6th Call for Proposals



6th Call for Proposals

Ensamble for folk dances songs “Veselin Masleša” | Banja Luka

Partners

- Center of Traditional Culture and Art „Kosta Abrašević“ | Bačka Palanka
- Folklore Association “Igraorec” | Skopje

Zmijanski Vez; Honoring tradition and Enriching the future

The project successfully brought together civil society organizations from Bosnia and Herzegovina, Serbia, and North Macedonia to promote cultural cooperation through a series of concerts, workshops, and lectures centered around the UNESCO-protected Zmijanski vez tradition. It strengthened people-to-people ties and regional reconciliation by engaging over 1,000 participants of all ages, especially youth, folklore enthusiasts, and cultural institutions. Citizens in Banja Luka, Bačka Palanka, and Skopje directly benefited through inclusive events that celebrated shared heritage and fostered long-term cultural exchange.

A workshop involving many young students in Banja Luka



Association for development, environment, and culture EKO ZH | Siroki Brijeg

Partners

- NVO Our action Montenegro | Kotor
- Environment Engineering Group | Novi Sad

Eco Friendly Colony

The project fostered interethnic cooperation and reconciliation among 30 young artists from Bosnia and Herzegovina, Serbia, and Montenegro through a week-long Eco-Friendly Colony in Nature Park Blidinje. Participants engaged in workshops, lectures, and art creation focused on ecology, history, and cultural heritage, strengthening intercultural dialogue and environmental awareness. The final beneficiaries included not only the young artists but also local communities, tourists, and associations supporting children with health issues, who received the artworks, giving the initiative a lasting social and cultural impact.

30
young artists
benefited directly
from this project

Participants pose for a picture in Blidinje Park, near Siroki Brijeg in Bosnia and Herzegovina



Center for Development Evaluation and Social Science Research | Sarajevo

Partners

- Public Policy Research Centre | Belgrade
- Universiteti i Shkodrës “Luigj Gurakuqi” | Shkodër

Western Balkans Initiative on Tackling Informal Unemployment on Online Platform

The project facilitated scientific exchange and education among partner institutions from Albania, Bosnia and Herzegovina, and Serbia, focusing on labour market informality and its impact on platform work. It produced a scientific paper, a regional policy paper, and organized national focus groups and regional events benefiting researchers, policymakers, CSOs, and informal workers by providing evidence-based insights to support better regulation and regional cooperation.

Ultimately, it strengthened academic collaboration, policy development, and public awareness across the Western Balkans.

100
people participated
and benefited
directly from this
project



Main Event

Association for Creation Stories Naratorium | Sarajevo

Partners

- Pobunjene čitateljke | Belgrade
- Coalition Margins | Skopje
- Booksa | Zagreb

Acknowledging contemporary feminist and queer literature in the Western Balkans: Shtefica Cvek #3

The project strengthened regional cooperation in the Western Balkans by promoting feminist literary voices and inclusive cultural practices that counter patriarchal and nationalist narratives. It directly benefited women, queer authors, young literary critics, and marginalized communities through research, awards, publications, events, and new models of readership. By amplifying underrepresented voices and fostering cross-border solidarity, the initiative laid the groundwork for a more inclusive and progressive regional literary space.

150
young female
authors competed
and **7** received
prizes for their
work



Presentation of the Awards in Sarajevo



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Proposals

Healthy Options Project Skopje (HOPS)

Partners

- Association Prevent | Novi Sad
- Association Labyrinth | Prishtinë

Youth and Gambling

The project explored one of the most difficult, yet largely unexplored, social challenge of our societies, the dependence from gambling. The project focused on the youth dependency, and analyzed the significant trends, differences and similarities in North Macedonia, Kosovo and Serbia. It analyzes both economic, social and legislative aspects of this complex issue. One report, translated in three languages was completed and shared among the Ministries of Education and other relevant institutions in the participating Contracting Parties



Poster of the report
displayed by HOPS

490
young people
under 30 benefited
directly from this
project

SouthEastern University of Tetovo | Tetovo

Partners

- Faculty of Public Administration, University of Sarajevo | Sarajevo
- Faculty of Economy, University "Ismail Qemali" Vlore | Vlorë
- Faculty of Political Science, University of Belgrade | Belgrade
- Fakultet za državne i evropske studije | Podgorica
- Faculty of Public Administration, AAB College | Prishtinë

Exploring Dimensions of Public Management, Policy, and Administration Across Diverse Sectors

The project boosted cooperation among public administrators and institutions of higher education in the Western Balkans. In total, 27 papers from all the six Contracting Parties were presented at the final conference held in Tetovo. The findings of the papers were focused on governance challenges in our Region. The initiative remains alive even after completion, with the universities and the participating institutions able to establish a long-lasting network of cooperation.

Presenting the findings of the project at the aula magna of the SouthEastern University of Tetovo



Association Phoenix Rising | Skopje

Partners

- Union of Young Entrepreneurs of Montenegro | Podgorica
- Association of Young Entrepreneurs Serbia | Belgrade

Exploring Dimensions of Public Management, Policy, and Administration Across Diverse Sectors

Branding products to make them as attractive as possible is very important for boosting regional exports and promoting sustainable entrepreneurship in the Western Balkans. The branding, as well as the challenges posed by legislative obstacles, were in center of the workshops and events organized by Phoenix Rising led partnership. The project supported not only network, but also concrete long-lasting partnership. Nine different cross-border collaborations were established during the event.



Darko Dimitrov,
the well-known
Macedonian
songwriter and
record producer was
one of the mentors
of this project

55
young
entrepreneurs
benefited directly
from this project



Main Event in Skopje

First Scout Unit of Skopje | Skopje

Partners

- Odred izviđača Dr Mladen Stojanovic | Prijedor
- Odred izviđača Josif Pančić | Nis
- Izviđački klub EHO | Podgorica

SCOUTSUNITED Learn it, do it, Scout it

The project successfully gathered 32 scouts from four Western Balkan countries, equipping them with skills in peacebuilding, intercultural learning, and communication through a five-day exchange in Ohrid. It enhanced regional cooperation, by establishing a multicultural youth network and promoted reconciliation by empowering participants to lead peacebuilding workshops in their communities. With over 400 youth engaged directly through follow-up activities, the project created lasting impact and laid the groundwork for continued collaboration among national scout associations in the region.

32
scouts
400
youngsters became
part of this unique
regional network



Scouts pose for a picture during the main event of the project in Ohrid



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Women Museum of Tirana | Tirana

Partners

- NVO NOVA Centar za feminističku kulturu | Podgorica
- Savez feminističkih organizacija “(Re)konekcija | Belgrade

Women transform the Balkans. Cultural bridge of the Regional Network

The project successfully established the “Women Transform the Balkans” network, bringing together women's museums, cultural institutions, and human rights organizations from Albania, Montenegro, and Serbia, with plans to expand further regionally. By promoting dialogue and combatting stereotypes through joint activities, it strengthened people-to-people ties and reconciliation.

99
women &
17
men benefited
from this project



At Destil CreativeHub, participants of the project unite for their main findings

SEKTRA

Partners

- Cultural Innovative Development Initiatives | Prizren
- Makenski Centar na ITI | Skopje

Virtual Tour of 3 Castles

The project boosted regional cooperation between three touristic locations, focusing on the Castles, surrounding bazars and cultural heritage in Skopje, Prizren and Lezhe. The digitalization of virtual tours was presented to the administration of those sites as a tribute to the local communities. By supporting the digitalization of the tours, Sektra and partners also supported a closer cooperation between archeologists, cultural heritage actors and economic stakeholders based in this environment.



Castle of Lezha, illustrative picture



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Albanian Open Mind Spectrum | Tirana

Partners

- CEL – Centre for Equality and Liberty | Prishtinë
- ERA - LGBTI Equal Association for Western Balkans and Turkey | Belgrade

Educating and empowering families for LGBTIQ+ in Albania – I AM YOUR CHILD!

The project successfully helped to boost regional cooperation in a delicate field, by connecting LGBTIQ+ families and allies from different countries to promote tolerance and understanding regionally. Through joint workshops and cross-border initiatives, participants gained exposure to diverse perspectives and developed empathy, helping to challenge prejudice and promote inclusive values. The primary beneficiaries were families navigating stigma and isolation, who found support and solidarity in a newly formed regional network that now serves as a foundation for long-term reconciliation and cooperation.

350+
young people &
20 parents shared
their resilient
experiences in the
framework



Workshop aiming to raise awareness and acceptance in Pogradec



6th
Call for
Proposals

Friends Association of Korça | Korçë

Partners

- Center for Sustainable Development | Bar
- Center for Sustainable Community Development | Debar
- Environmental Ambassadors for Sustainable Development | Belgrade
- Environment Improvement Center | Belgrade
- University Fan Noli of Korçë | Korçë
- Tirana Polytechnic University | Tiranë
- Albanian Association of Renewable Energy | Tiranë
- DIHA, German Association of Industry and Commerce in Albania | Tiranë
- Sos Malta | Santa Venera, Malta

Solar Schools for Green Transition

The project achieved its key objectives by boosting collaboration between schools, CSOs, and local governments, empowering over 180 youth with environmental education and generating concrete proposals for solar energy projects. The main product of the project is a long lasting network, established among the stakeholders.

140
actors became
part of the newly
established
platform for Solar
Energy



Main event and presentation of Findings in Korça



ERC
Grant
Scheme



ERC
Grant
Scheme

Belgrade Center for Security Policy | Belgrade

Partners

- Kosovar Centre for Security Studies, KCSS(Prishtina)
- Centre for Security Studies – BiH (Sarajevo)
- Albanian Institute for International Studies (Tirana)
- Center for the Study of Democracy and Governance (Tirana)

Building Bridges: Empowering Youth in the WB

The project made a substantial contribution by building the capacities of young leaders, facilitating meaningful knowledge transfer, and enabling youth-led advocacy across the Western Balkans. These contributions were directly linked to the project's outcomes and deliverables and are expected to have lasting effects beyond the project's implementation period. Through

From the BSC Security Conference 2024



two regional events in Belgrade and Tirana, the project empowered 31 young leaders from six Western Balkan Contracting Parties with critical knowledge and skills related to regional cooperation, democratic participation, and advocacy. Participants engaged in high-level workshops, simulations, expert-led sessions, and peer-learning activities, all designed to build practical competencies.

31
Young Leaders
benefited directly
from this project

Journalist Association of Serbia | Belgrade

Partners

- The Albanian Center for Quality Journalism (Tirana)
- The Media Center (Čaglavica)
- Centar za razvoj omladinskog aktivizma (CROA) (Sarajevo)

How to use AI in Media

The project contributed to strengthening the capacities of young journalists and journalism students through the organization of four workshops held in Belgrade, Sarajevo, Tirana, and Čaglavica, with a total of 104 participants. Through lectures and practical sessions, participants gained knowledge about the use of artificial intelligence (AI) tools in journalism, with a particular focus on ethical standards and the responsible use of new technologies.

104
journalists
benefited from the
workshops held in
4 locations

These activities directly responded to the target group's need for professional development in line with contemporary media challenges.

Additionally, a comprehensive training program on the ethical and professional use of AI was developed and implemented, which can be used for future educational efforts.

One of the workshops held in Belgrade





ERC
Grant
Scheme



ERC
Grant
Scheme

Centar za afirmaciju sporta i mladih | Podgorica

Partners

- Udruženje za sport i rekreaciju "Altair" (Sarajevo)
- Teqball United (Novi Sad)
- Tekbol Asocijacija Severna Makedonija (Skopje)
- Albanian Teqball Association (Tirana)
- Federata e Teqbollit e Kosoves (Prishtine)
- Teqball savez Crne Gore (Podgorica)

TEQ Balkan: Empowering CS in the WB through Sustainable Sport Initiatives

The project had a strong regional impact, training 99 final beneficiaries in essential areas such as grant writing, youth engagement, advocacy, and policy alignment. Through workshops held in Podgorica, Tirana, and Pristina, it facilitated cross-border knowledge exchange on funding mechanisms, sports policy, and best practices in youth engagement, significantly strengthening regional cooperation. The project also delivered concrete results aligned with ERC objectives, including signed Memoranda of Cooperation, strengthened regional partnerships, and participation in international events in Shkoder, Sarajevo, and Ohrid, all of which underscore its long-term contribution to cooperation and capacity-building in the region.



99
final beneficiaries
benefited from this
project

From the
Conference held
in Podgorica

Alpha Centre | Nikšić

Partners

- Youth Center "Perspektiva" (Durrës)
- Horizon Civitas (Skopje)
- Sbunker (Pristina)
- Strukovno udruženje sektora bezbjednosti (Belgrade)
- Humanity in Action (Sarajevo)

Strengthening Media Literacy to Counter Disinformation on EU Integration Among WB Youth

The project achieved significant results particularly in increasing capacities, knowledge transfer, and advocacy. It directly trained 70 participants, equipping them with critical thinking and media literacy skills essential for navigating today's complex information landscape. The development of a prototype board game introduced an innovative and interactive tool to support media literacy and EU integration education, with the potential to reach broader audiences. Awareness-raising efforts successfully reached over 370 individuals.

70
participants were
equipped directly
with skills on
how to combat
disinformation
online

370
people benefited
indirectly from the
project



Final Conference
of the project held
in Podgorica

Chamber of Trade and Industry of Kosovo | Prishtinë

Partners

- Economic Chamber of North-West Macedonia (Skopje)
- Chamber of Trade Dures (Dures)
- Chamber of Economy of Montenegro (Podgorica)
- Environmental and Social Responsibility Association ESRA(Prishtinë)
- Yesfor Less(Ohrid)

ESGWB6 Promotion Platform

The ESGWB6 Promotion Platform, led by the Chamber of Trade and Industry Kosovo in collaboration with ESRA, successfully established a strong foundation for promoting Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) practices across the Western Balkans. Through the involvement of over 100 beneficiaries and a wide network of regional experts, the project supported cross-sector collaboration between public institutions, the private sector, and civil society organizations.

100+
beneficiaries,
including a wide
network of regional
experts, public
institutions and civil
society

Final conference held in Prishtina



Institute for Social Policy "Musine Kokalari" | Prishtinë

Partners

- Safety at Work Association of Montenegro (Podgorica)
- Center for the Politics of Emancipation (Belgrade)
- ZORA - Association for social, cultural and creative development (Zenica)

Decent Work Academy in WB

The Regional Decent Work Academy played a crucial role in enhancing regional cooperation by providing a platform for key stakeholders to come together and engage in meaningful dialogue on labor rights. By fostering connections between trade union representatives, NGO leaders, and labor rights experts, the academy promoted the sharing of best practices and successful advocacy strategies. The event's interactive workshops and plenary sessions facilitated a deeper understanding of the shared challenges faced by workers across the Western Balkans, particularly in areas such as living wages, gender equality, and labor law gaps.

50
organisations
benefited directed
from the project





ERC
Grant
Scheme



ERC
Grant
Scheme

Dis Theater Banja Luka

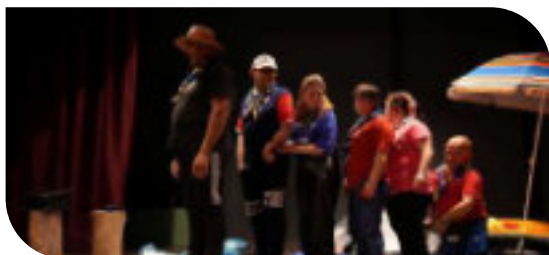
Partners

- Center “The Door” (Shkoder)
- CEKOM Centar za kreativno odrastanje i multikulturalnu saradnju (Zrenjanin)
- Theatre Pi - Skopje

SPARK— Stage for Promoting Arts, Reconciliation, and Knowledge

The SPARK project directly benefited 50 artists across the Western Balkans, empowering them through targeted capacity-building, creative collaboration, and advocacy-focused artistic expression. The artists participated in specialized training led by international experts, enhancing their skills in inclusive theatre production and ecological storytelling. Through cross-border exchanges and mentorship, particularly from DIS Teatar in Banja Luka, they embraced innovative methods that elevated both the artistic and social impact of their work. As a result, the project not only fostered greater disability inclusion and ecological awareness in the arts but also built a vibrant regional network of socially engaged artists committed to lasting change.

50
artists, including artists with Down Syndrome or other disabilities benefited directly from the project.



One of the teatral events held by Teatar of Banja Luka

Centar za psiholosku podršku Sensus| Mostar

Partners

- Association “Halfway there” (Pancevo)
- Association of psychologists Novi Pazar (Novi Pazar)
- Association of Psychologists of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina (Sarajevo)
- Center for the affirmation of Rome and Egyptians -CAREP (Niksic)
- Kosovo Young Lawyers-KYL (Prishtinë)
- Center for Development and Integration (Tiranë)

Regional Talks about Mental Health



Workshop in Mostar, raising awareness on the importance of mental health

The project made a substantial contribution to the ERC call objectives by advancing mental health advocacy, capacity-building, and knowledge transfer across the Western Balkans. Through comprehensive regional research involving 2,361 respondents, it established a vital evidence base on the mental health challenges faced by marginalized groups in Bosnia and Herzegovina, Serbia, Montenegro, Kosovo and Albania. This data informed the development of a practical manual, “Risks for Mental Health and Their Treatment,” equipping CSOs and institutions with actionable strategies to address these risks.

2361
people became part of this project



ERC
Grant
Scheme



ERC
Grant
Scheme

NGO Planktonium | Skopje

Partners

- Advocacy Training and Resource Center – ATRC (Prishtina)
- EDMi Centre (EcoDESIGN and Management Institute) (Tirana)
- NGO Zeleni Dom- Green Home (Podgorica)

Establishing waste management associations

One of the key achievements of the project was the initiation of structured, cross-sector cooperation among civil society organizations, municipalities, utility companies, and national institutions in Kosovo, Montenegro, and Albania. By opening dialogue on the creation of national waste management associations, the project laid a practical foundation for ongoing collaboration, ensuring that CSOs are included in decision-making processes on environmental issues. The initiative successfully addressed the first ERC objective by connecting environmental organizations across four countries and facilitating their engagement with public institutions, using the Macedonian Solid Waste Association (MaSWA) as a proven model of civil society-led cooperation.

A member of the project displaying recycled waste to other participants in Skopje



HERA – Health Education and Research

Association | Skopje

Partners

- Center for Population policies and sustainable development - IPPF Serbia (Belgrade)
- Organization for Increasing Quality of Education (ORCA) (Prishtina)
- Civic Resistance (Tirana)

Empowering Youth for Democratic and Sustainable Futures in the Western Balkans

The project effectively supported 211 beneficiaries, including CSOs, youth leaders, and policymakers, through a series of targeted workshops, knowledge-sharing sessions, and advocacy initiatives. These efforts strengthened participants' ability to engage in democratic processes and promote inclusive, youth-oriented policies. The project also facilitated knowledge transfer through regional policy assessments and high-level dialogues, ensuring that findings and best practices were shared across borders.

211

beneficiaries,
including CSOs,
youth leaders, and
policymakers

Family Picture of the HERA Final
Conference





ERC
Grant
Scheme



ERC
Grant
Scheme

Council of the Albanian Ambassadors

Partners

- Atlantic Council of Bosnia and Hercegovina (ACBiH) (Sarajevo)
- The Institute for Sustainable Democratic Development (Prishtine)
- Horizonti i Ri (Ulcinj)
- Council of Ambassadors of North Macedonia (Skopje)
- Albanian National Council of Montenegro (Ulcinj)

The project made a strong contribution by significantly enhancing the capacities of civil society organizations (CSOs) across the Western Balkans. Through two high-level regional workshops and complementary activities, over 125 CSO representatives received hands-on training from experienced former ministers, ambassadors, and senior diplomats. These sessions equipped participants with essential skills in diplomatic communication, public speaking, advocacy, and cultural sensitivity, boosting their confidence and effectiveness in engaging with governments, international actors, and media platforms.

125
CSOs have
benefited from the
workshops held in
Skopje and Durrës

From the final event held in Durrës, Albania



Helsinki Committee | Tirana

Partners

- Helsinki Committee for Human Rights in Serbia (Belgrade)
- Civil Rights Program Kosovo (Prishtine)
- The Helsinki Committee for Human Rights in North Macedonia (Skopje)

The Digitalization of Public Administration and Personal Data Protection: Approaching EU Integration Attentively

The project made a substantial contribution by strengthening capacities, facilitating knowledge transfer, and advancing advocacy in the field of public administration (PA) digitalization in the Western Balkans. Through targeted workshops, such as the one held in Ohrid, regional institutions and civil society organizations (CSOs) were equipped with the knowledge and tools to engage in digital transformation processes, while addressing critical issues like data protection, cybersecurity, and human rights.

Final Conference, Tirana





7TH Call for Proposals

This is not just a celebration of selected projects.

It is a celebration of ideas, of trust, of partnership and above all, of the strong belief that regional cooperation is not merely a concept, but a living reality we are building, one project, one collaboration, one handshake at a time.

None of this would have been possible without the support of the European Union.

Dr. Gjergj Murra, Executive Director of the Western Balkans Fund, at the official Awarding Ceremony underscored the broader significance of the grants.

The 7th Call for Proposals, co-funded by the European Union, is at the time of the publication of this report under implementation.

TIMETABLE OF THE 7TH CALL FOR PROPOSALS





Thirty (30) new regional grants to “Support to the Promotion of Civil Society Regional Actions in the Western Balkans” project.

In early May 2025, the Western Balkans Fund awarded 30 new regional grants to Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) across the region, as part of the second phase of the “Support to the Promotion of Civil Society Regional Actions in the Western Balkans” project, co-funded by the European Union.

This grant round, part of the 7th Call for Proposals of the WBF–EU Joint Action, reaffirms WBF’s commitment to empowering local actors and strengthening regional cooperation through inclusive and impactful civil society engagement.

A total of 139 beneficiary organizations acting either as lead applicants or partners are involved in the 30 selected projects, representing 32 different locations across the Western Balkans. The selection process was highly

competitive, with a record-breaking 416 applications received. Notably, the distribution of lead applicants was balanced across all Contracting Parties, ensuring equal representation and ownership across the region.

Mr. Fjordi Bisha, Project Manager of the WBF–EU Joint Action, highlighted the scale and inclusivity of the Call: “The record number of 416 applications reflects both the inclusiveness and the credibility of our Joint Action.”

The awarded projects span a wide range of thematic areas, including regional cooperation, education, culture, sustainable development, the green agenda, gender equality, and the promotion of human rights, demonstrating the diversity and relevance of civil society priorities across the region.

30 winning projects of the 7th Call for Proposals



Title of the Project: VEOYO - Bogdan Bogdanović: Montenegro, Serbia and BiH connected by monumental heritage

Lead Grantee:
VOM Center in Belgrade

Regional Partners:

- Ustanička gimnazija Beograd / Hercegovina, Banja Luka
- Muzej Zvezda za mlade na spomeniku na kulturni i kulni - Prije
- Muzej Zvezda za mlade na spomeniku na kulturni i kulni - Zagreb
- Center 20 kulturni "Morio Gopovik", Prije
- Architectural Faculty, University of Belgrade
- Center za Kulturni Muzej



Title of the Project: ECHO: The Serbian School Social Engagement and Outreach

Lead Grantee:
Institute for Philosophy and Social Theory

Regional Partners:

- Institute for Advanced Study, University of Montenegro in Podgorica
- University of Sarajevo, Sarajevo

General Objective:
To enhance youth participation in environmental governance across the Western Balkans by integrating youth perspectives into Green Agenda policymaking and fostering regional cooperation for inclusive and sustainable development.



Title of the Project: PRONA - Western Balkans Science Academy

Lead Grantee:
Foundation Prona in Podgorica

Regional Partners:

- Doh Teacher in Belgrade
- Faculty of Science and Mathematics, University of Montenegro in Podgorica
- Mathematical Science / Hercegovina in Sarajevo

General Objective:
To enhance the regional cooperation and social inclusion in the Western Balkans by improving accessibility in cultural institutions for people with sensory impairments through introduction of inclusive



Title of the Project: JENI: Strengthening dialogue with civil society for enhanced communication and cooperation in the Western Balkans region

Lead Grantee:
JENI: Civil Society NGO in Herceg Novi

Regional Partners:

- SAK 20 djevojačica Sarajevo
- Civil Society Initiative in Belgrade
- Ustanička "mreža" in Ljubljana
- NGO SAND in Sarajevo
- Ustanička Križevica in Zagreb

General Objective:
To foster regional cooperation and social integration of young career partners in the Western Balkans by creating a cross-institutional network support career training and job satisfaction training



Title of the Project: DISCOVER SERBIA: Master Future - Region's Future

Lead Grantee:
Discover Serbia in Prije

Regional Partners:

- Oboznanje Vilagrad
- INOVIS in Sarajevo
- Oboznanje SARAJEVO

General Objective:
To contribute to sustainable development and regional economic growth in the Western Balkans by addressing cross-sectoral challenges through research with management, innovation, promotion, and sustainable cooperation.



Title of the Project: A: Museum open to all

Lead Grantee:
ASSOCIATION of the Deaf and Hard of Hearing of Montenegro in Podgorica

Regional Partners:

- Cultural Centre Miroslav Krleža
- The Deaf and Hard of Hearing Association of Serbia (DHS) in Belgrade
- ARAD in Thess

General Objective:
To strengthen regional scientific cooperation and integration in the Western Balkans by providing STEM education, fostering youth-led innovation, and building cross-border networks of young researchers and mentors.



Title of the Project: PUN: Back to the Stars, Using the Western Balkans through Science & Astronomy

Lead Grantee:
Astronomy Club of Kosovo in Pristina

Regional Partners:

- Astronomical Society OARU in Sarajevo
- Group Astronomical Society in Skopje
- EduArt Albans in Thess
- ROM 15 Club for Youth Engagement in Novi Pazar
- Network for Youth Action of Montenegro - YOAAC in Podgorica
- Astronomical Society Research in Podgorica
- Astronomical Society: Youth
- Astronomical Society in Belgrade
- ACK / Pristina Observatory & CoPartners in Pristina



Title of the Project: CPCD: Young Balkan New Age, New Approach

Lead Grantee:
Center for promoting civil society in Sarajevo

Regional Partners:

- Gender Knowledge Hub in Novi Sad
- Center for Democratic Transition in Podgorica

General Objective:
To strengthen project management and writing capacities of CSOs and institutions in the Western Balkans, fostering regional cooperation and cross-border partnerships through shared learning and collaboration



Title of the Project: AAB: Students for Sustainable Development: Knowledge Sharing for Environmentally Responsible Practices

Lead Grantee:
AAB College in Pristina

Regional Partners:

- British College of Science in Pristina
- Mother Teresa University in Skopje
- South East European University: Faculty of Contemporary Social Sciences in Sarajevo
- JU Center for Vocational Education in Podgorica
- University of Montenegro in Podgorica
- Justice Achievement Montenegro in Podgorica



Title of the Project: UNIVERSITY OF NOVI SAD: Engineering Occupational Safety and Health for Sustainable Development in the Western Balkans (ESOH4WB)

Lead Grantee:
University of Novi Sad, Faculty of Technical Sciences

Regional Partners:

- Sarajevo School of Science and Technology in Sarajevo
- St. Cyril and Methodius University in Skopje, Faculty of Mechanical Engineering in Skopje

General Objective:
To strengthen regional cooperation in occupational health and safety (OHS) across the Western Balkans by harmonizing policies, building sustainable capacities, and promoting inclusive and sustainable workplace practices



Opština Nikšić

Title of the Project: Generating Opportunities Through Arts, Talent & Nature (GROWTH)

Lead Grantee: Opština Nikšić

Regional Partners:

- Thelaga Development Agency (TRIDEA) in Thelaga
- Center for Sustainable Community Development Delta
- Municipality of Krivopalje

General Objective:

To enhance empathy among youth and unemployed individuals in the Western Balkans through business experience, mentorship and the promotion of sustainable business models, empowering them with key skills contributing integral education to a vision of sustainable development.



Title of the Project: NEI Forum Forum: Regional Economic Cooperation Through Innovation

Lead Grantee: Podgorica Forum SDC in Podgorica

Regional Partners:

- International SDC in Albania in Tirana
- Foreign Investor Council in Skopje

General Objective:

To support early-stage startup growth in the Western Balkans by improving access to financing, strengthening investment networks, and fostering regional cooperation among young entrepreneurs.



Title of the Project: Balkan STEAM Innovation Camp

Lead Grantee: Edgarden in Podgorica

Regional Partners:

- Children's Rights Center Albanian Theatre
- Center for Education and Development in Tirana

General Objective:

To enhance STEM education and regional cooperation in the Western Balkans by providing high school students with hands-on STEM learning experiences, fostering cross-border collaboration, and empowering future STEM leaders.



Title of the Project: Colony of Visual Artists of Western Balkans – 3725: Meaningful Dialogues, Peace, and Reconciliation

Lead Grantee: Friends of Kopa Association in Skopje

Regional Partners:

- Institutions in Skopje
- CSO Kopa in Belgrade
- Center of Art and Culture Municipality of Kopa

General Objective:

To enhance regional cooperation and cultural dialogue among artists in the Western Balkans, using visual arts to promote peace, reconciliation, and a shared regional identity.



Title of the Project: Account Mountains – Green Gender Science (MAMOUNT)

Lead Grantee: NGO Green Home in Podgorica

Regional Partners:

- Environmentally Responsible Action (ERA) in Peja
- Institute for nature conservation in Albania in Tirana

General Objective:

To strengthen cross-border cooperation and good neighborly relations between Montenegro, Albania, and Kosovo by providing regional dialogue, scientific exchange, and youth engagement in the field of nature protection and environmental sustainability.



Title of the Project: Break Map Max Dizdaj Foundation

Lead Grantee: Dizdaj Foundation in Sarajevo

Regional Partners:

- Muzey Ruc in Novi Pazar
- Zavod za muzejstvo "Kosovo kula" in Kosovo

General Objective:

To strengthen regional cooperation and people-to-people links in the Western Balkans through the preservation and promotion of local as a shared cultural heritage, engaging youth, communities, and institutions in cross-border collaboration and digital innovation.



Title of the Project: "Bridge of the Balkans" – Regional Manufacturing Cooperation

Lead Grantee: Association for Cooperation and Development Forum in Medica

Regional Partners:

- Manufacturing and Design Association Pribina in Medica
- Manufacturing Club "Tijeban" in Tbilisi
- Manufacturing cluster "Industrial Market"

General Objective:

To foster regional cooperation and people-to-people links in the Western Balkans by promoting environmental sustainability and outdoor tourism as drivers of economic and social development.



Title of the Project: Community Foundations – Enhancing Local Philanthropy in the WB

Lead Grantee: Association of United Skopje

Regional Partners:

- Youth Community Foundation in Tuzla
- Trig Foundation in Belgrade

General Objective:

To enhance the competitiveness and sustainability of emerging tourism in the Western Balkans by empowering local communities through cross-border collaboration, skills development, and promotion of the region's wine and culinary culture.



Title of the Project: Theatre for All

Lead Grantee: National Theatre of Republic of Serbia in Belgrade

Regional Partners:

- Narodno pozorište in Belgrade
- Opatovska narodno pozorište in Podgorica

General Objective:

To promote inclusive and accessible theater across Bosnia and Herzegovina, Serbia, and Montenegro by fostering regional cooperation, cross-sector collaboration, and mass cultural participation for people with disabilities.



Title of the Project: Creative Vibe

Lead Grantee: Studio Opus in Kosovo

Regional Partners:

- Udruženje "Iskustvenik" in the community of Zlatibor in Tuzla
- Association of Music Educators Polytechnic in Skopje
- NGO "Zvezda" in Podgorica

General Objective:

To foster inter-cultural dialogue and regional cooperation in the Western Balkans by encouraging young musicians from diverse ethnic and cultural backgrounds to explore, interpret, and promote the region's shared musical heritage through collaborative creation and performance.



Title of the Project: Footstep to Successful STEAM Festivals

Lead Grantee: Association Multispace Garage in Medica

Regional Partners:

- NGO Digital Arts in Podgorica
- Montenegro SDC in Skopje

General Objective:

To foster inter-ethnic collaboration, regional cooperation, and people-to-people links among youth in the Western Balkans through artistry and science-based exchange.



Title of the Project: Cultivating the Revolution Tourism in the Western Balkans Region

Lead Grantee: Winos of Macedonia in Skopje

Regional Partners:

- National Association of Sommeliers Montenegro in Podgorica
- Association of sommeliers, winemakers and wine-growers in Novi Pazar

General Objective:

To foster the emergence and growth of community foundations in the Western Balkans by strengthening regional cooperation, expanding knowledge, and building people-to-people links.



Title of the Project: Game Days: Empowering Women in the Gaming Industry

Lead Grantee: Montenegro Gaming Industry Association in Skopje

Regional Partners:

- Serbian Gaming Association in Belgrade
- OIC Committee in Tirana

General Objective:

To empower women in the Western Balkans gaming industry by fostering regional cooperation, promoting gender diversity, and creating opportunities for women to foster through capacity-building, mentorship, and networking.



Title of the Project: Tourism Users Innovator: Regional Network for Actions and Digital Innovation

Lead Grantee: Oda Ndromonensis Zogajevic Prizren

Regional Partners:

- The National Chamber of Crafts in Tirana
- The Chamber of Crafts in Skopje

General Objective:

To strengthen regional cultural cooperation and people-to-people links in the Western Balkans by promoting traditional crafts, fostering cross-border dialogue, and connecting artists, artisans, artists, and crafts through cross-border collaboration and digital innovation.



Title of the Project: CINEBALK: Capturing the Balkans' Cinematic Heritage through Digital Storytelling

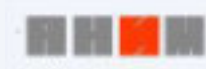
Lead Grantee: Winos of Macedonia in Skopje

Regional Partners:

- Film International in Skopje
- Cinéma in Podgorica
- Independent production promoters – Zlat in Podgorica
- Film Academy Institute in Podgorica
- Film festival producers in Kosovo in Herceg Novi in Sarajevo

General Objective:

To foster the emergence and growth of community foundations in the Western Balkans by strengthening regional cooperation, expanding knowledge, and building people-to-people links.



Title of the Project: Education Peace Art is the Way

Lead Grantee: Peace Art in Podgorica

Regional Partners:

- Civic Initiatives in Belgrade
- NGO Inigo in Podgorica

General Objective:

To strengthen regional cooperation and people-to-people links by empowering youth cultural activities and artists from least developed, Kosovo, and Serbia to promote intercultural dialogue and reconciliation through art.



Title of the Project: Youth Engagement for Empowerment of the Balkans

Lead Grantee: Balkan Institute for Regional Cooperation in Tirana

Regional Partners:

- Center for Innovation and Development in Podgorica
- MVO Gelo in Podgorica

General Objective:

To foster inter-ethnic collaboration, regional cooperation, and people-to-people links among youth in the Western Balkans through artistry and science-based exchange.



Title of the Project: RIZKUN CANCER FORUM Cross-Border Care – Strengthening Support Networks for Women with Breast Cancer

Lead Grantee: Europa Cancer Alliance in Tirana

Regional Partners:

- Perennium in Podgorica
- PTDA – Association for Development
- Institute for Health Care, Improvement of Health Care Services in Skopje

General Objective:

To enhance regional cooperation and cultural dialogue among artists in the Western Balkans, using visual arts to promote peace, reconciliation, and a shared regional identity. The project will foster cooperation among artists to create cultural events, strengthen networks, and use visual storytelling for social cohesion.



Title of the Project: Agriculture Inspiring Youth in the Western Balkans to Embrace Agriculture

Lead Grantee: Society Center for Excellence

Regional Partners:

- Gender Center for Gender in Tirana
- Environmental Action Organization Association (EAO) in Podgorica
- "Innovation Key" (Inovativni Ključ) in Podgorica

General Objective:

To empower youth from Albania, Kosovo, and Montenegro as active contributors to agricultural and rural development through regional cooperation and people-to-people connections.



Title of the Project: Green Film Network

Lead Grantee: Open Mind Spectrum Albania (OMSA) in Tirana

Regional Partners:

- Montenegro LGBTIQ Association Gelo in Podgorica
- Center for Equality and Liberty Kosovo (CEL), in Podgorica

General Objective:

To improve public perceptions and media attitudes towards LGBTIQ individuals in Montenegro, Albania, Kosovo, and the Western Balkans by promoting queer culture and art through regional cooperation and cultural exchange.

Record participation Informative sessions

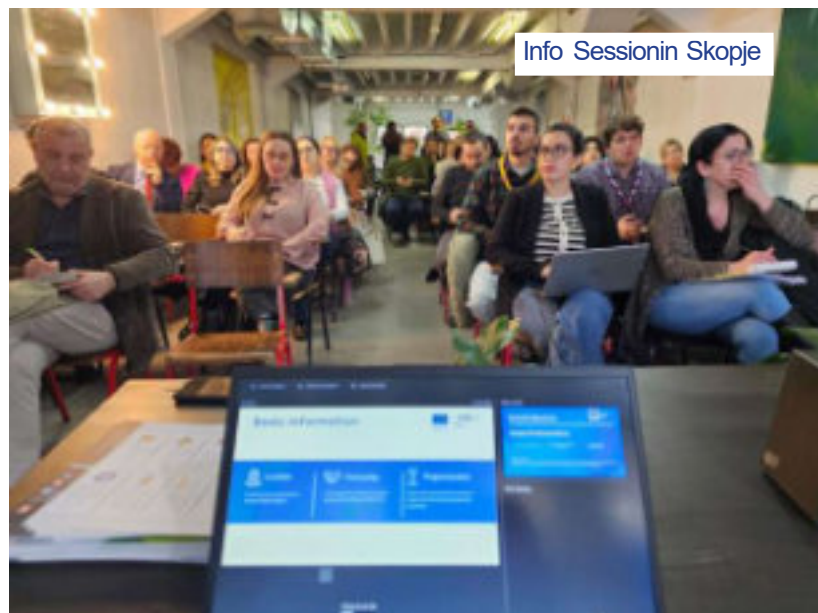
In January and February 2025, WBF visited 12 cities, two per each Contracting Party generating an unprecedented attention, which resulted in a record number of applications

The Call for Proposals launched are always accompanied with an extensive tour of the Region, where designated teams of the Western Balkans Fund engage in direct communication with the interested applicants in different cities. In all tours, WBF teams visit the six capitals of the Contracting Parties and the second city, selected based on geographical criteria. Occasionally, we engage also in less formal Informative Days, that do happen in different locations of the Region. To complete the tour, we also do provide several opportunities to engage in online Info Sessions, in English and all the official languages of the Region.



In our recent tour, between 27 January and 5 February 2025, the Western Balkans Fund conducted a highly successful series of 12 in-person Informative Sessions in the following locations: Belgrade and Novi Sad; Skopje and Prilep; Prishtina and Prizren; Tirana and Elbasan; Podgorica and Budva; Sarajevo and Mostar.

The sessions attracted a record of over 500 participants, including representatives from civil society organizations, public institutions, and grassroots initiatives. Their active engagement reflected the strong and growing interest in the WBF–EU Joint Action Call for Proposals.





Info Sessionin Prizren



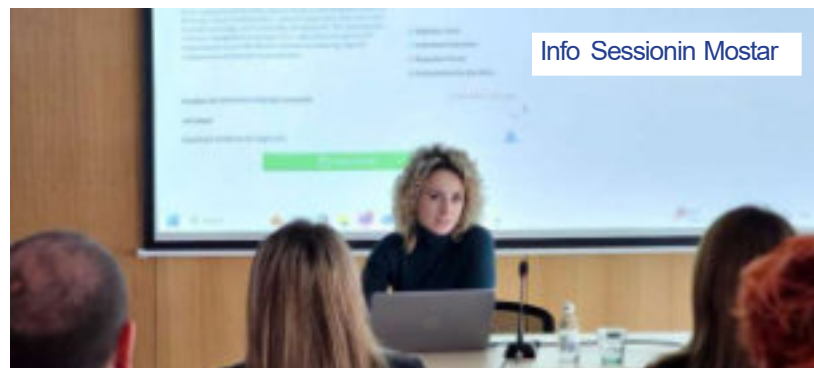
Info Sessionin Sarajevo



Info Sessionin Podgorica



Info Sessionin Novi Sad



Info Sessionin Mostar



Info Sessionin Budva



Info Sessionin Tirana



Info Sessionin Prishtina

Partnership Workshop with the grantees of the 7th CFP

From May 6–7, 2025, alongside the Awarding Ceremony of the 4th Call for Proposals of the Joint Action, we held different sessions of the Partnership Workshop.

These sessions were carefully crafted to help grantee implement their projects in full alignment with regional priorities and European standards, while also strengthening cross-border cooperation and community engagement.

Key areas of focus:

- Financial management and reporting practices in line with transparency and accountability standards.
- Project design and implementation methodologies, encouraging strategic planning and measurable outcomes.
- Effective use of the Online Grant Management Platform for seamless administration.
- Outreach, visibility, and communication strategies to amplify the impact and reach of each project.

Secretariat delivering a Partnership Workshop in Golem 6-8 May 2025





Tirana, Europa Donna Albania and partners establishing a regional platform to combat breast cancer



Perucak Dam, cleaning of the River Drina, as part of a project lead by Discover Serbia



Novi Sad, a project focused on the right of workers is currently ongoing



Prilep, PeaceAction drama about mass migration in the WB Region



Game Divas, of Macedonian Gaming Industry, a project focused on the empowerment of women and girls in the field of programming and gaming industry

Podgorica, Youth Engagement for the Europeanisation of the Western Balkans project



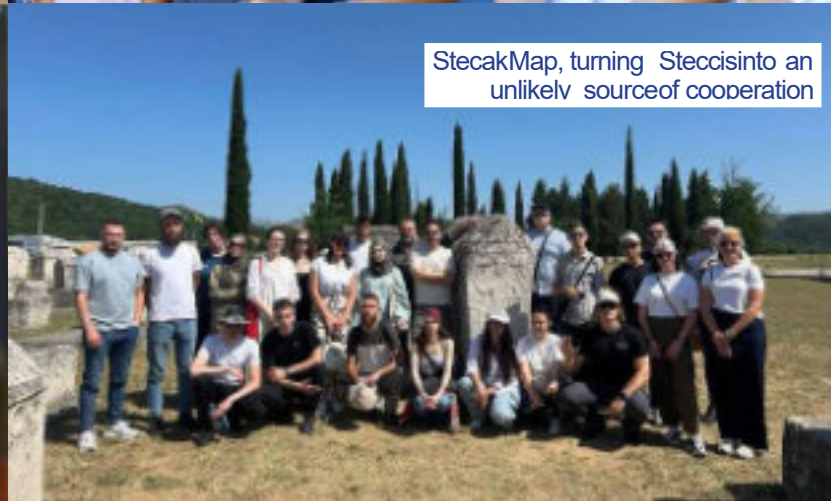
President of Montenegro, H.E. Milatovic, visiting a summer school funded by WBF in Lovcen



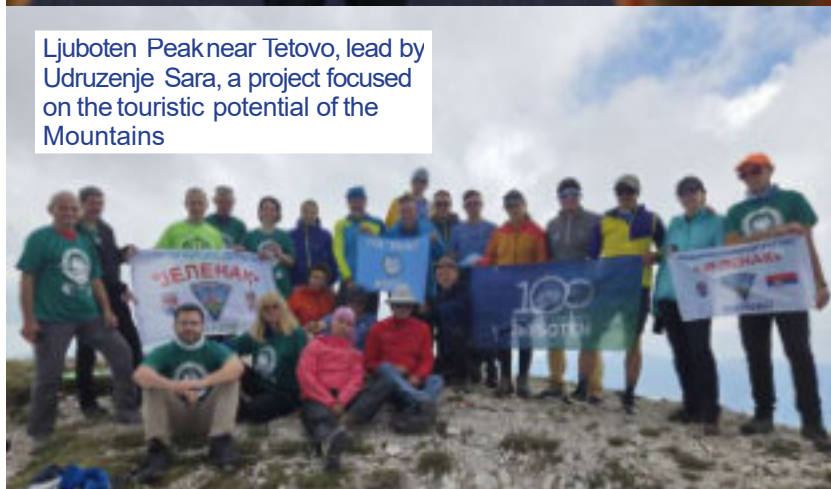
Keiretsu Forum in Prishtina



StecakMap, turning Steccis into an unlikely source of cooperation



Ljuboten Peak near Tetovo, lead by Udrusenje Sara, a project focused on the touristic potential of the Mountains



Petnica. Creative Vibes project on a night



MOVE Grants

Enhancing people to people links in the Region

The WBF MOVE Grant Mechanism offers a unique opportunity for citizens across the Western Balkans to engage in mobility activities that promote cross-border cooperation and interpersonal exchange. Launched in March 2023, MOVE has quickly proven to be a flexible and high-impact program, connecting individuals from all six Contracting Parties and spanning a diverse range of sectors, including education, culture, economic development, digitalization, and environmental protection.

Over the period June 2023 to July 2025, the MOVE Grants has supported 141 mobility projects, each contributing to the Fund's broader mission of building trust, encouraging regional dialogue and generating innovative ideas for future collaboration. The grants have been especially impactful in reaching applicants from non-capital and underrepresented areas, reinforcing WBF's inclusive approach and expanding its geographic footprint across the region.

What consistently stands out among MOVE grantees is their passion and commitment clearly reflected in how they leverage this opportunity to drive positive change through grassroots action, knowledge exchange, and community engagement. MOVE has served as a catalyst for new partnerships, shared initiatives, and long-term regional synergies.

A notable achievement of the WBF MOVE Grants is the strong gender balance among applicants, with a nearly even split of 53% women and 47% men.



In terms of thematic focus, MOVE Grants attract broad interest across all eligible sectors. The top three areas of engagement include Culture, Education and Scientific Research, and Economic Development and Digitalization. However, the wide range of activities supported by MOVE ensures that all fields of intervention available under the scheme receive attention, underscoring the program's flexibility and adaptability to diverse regional needs.

Feedback from MOVE grantees consistently highlights high satisfaction with the Fund's grant management approach. WBF's dedicated staff assigned to each Contracting Party play a crucial role in overcoming language barriers, addressing implementation challenges, and providing hands-on mentoring and guidance. This personalized support has been instrumental in equipping grantees with the necessary tools and information to successfully manage their projects and maximize their impact.

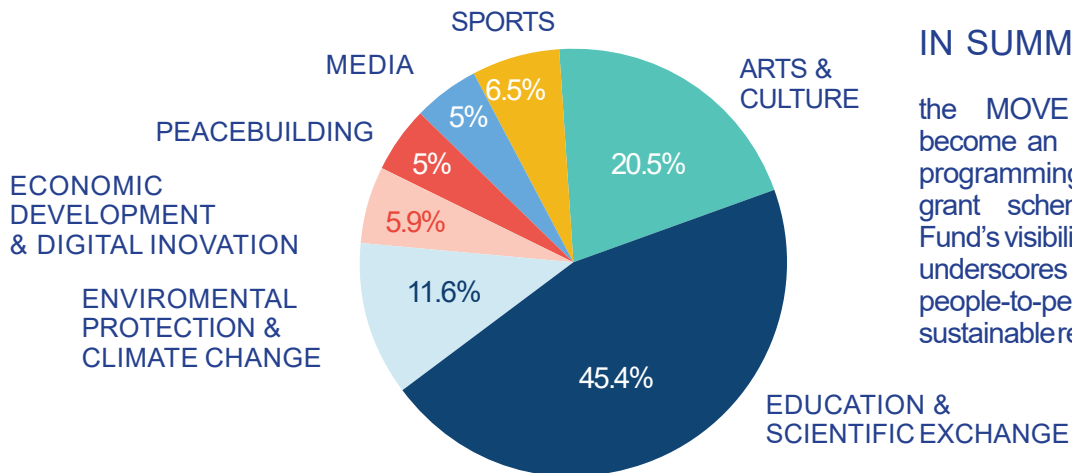


Selected pictures from the WBF Move Projects

Projects as per the area of intervention (applications)

Our beneficiaries range from:

- Researchers
- Students
- Professors
- Journalists
- Actors
- Artists
- Activists
- Musicians
- Experts
- Doctors
- etc. ...



IN SUMMARY

the MOVE Grant Mechanism has become an integral part of the WBF's programming, complementing core grant schemes while enhancing the Fund's visibility and outreach. Its success underscores the value of investing in people-to-people links as a foundation for sustainable regional cooperation.

Western Balkans Visegrad Fellowship

Launched in 2024 as a joint initiative between the Western Balkans Fund (WBF) and the International Visegrad Fund (IVF), the Western Balkans – Visegrad Fellowship aims to foster academic exchange and strengthen research collaboration between scholars from the Western Balkans (WB6) and the Visegrad countries (Czechia, Hungary, Poland, and Slovakia).

In its inaugural year, the program awarded fellowships to 41 beneficiaries, enabling scholars, lecturers, and researchers to undertake short-term research stays at host institutions across both regions. Building on the Fellowship's early success, the second Call

for Proposals was launched in 2025 attracting 104 applications from scholars throughout the Western Balkans and Visegrad countries. The evaluation process resulted in 44 new fellows, that will have their Fellowships in the respective Regions from September 25th to June 26th.

The growing popularity of the Fellowship highlights its significance as a vital platform for academic partnership and collaboration. It continues to contribute meaningfully to the development of bilateral ties and to the promotion of knowledge exchange, supporting the broader objectives of regional cooperation between the Western Balkans and the Visegrad Group.





CHAPTER 3

THE FUND BEYOND THE GRANTS

- A new open forum made-in WBF
- Building Capacities for the Culture and Creative Industries
- Building Synergies among local communities



A new open forum for the Western Balkans

The Regional Networking and Dialogue Sessions (RNDS), a new initiative that encourages widescale dialogue between civil society organisations, institutions and experts in the WB



FINDINGS AND
RECOMMENDATIONS OF
THE RNDS SESSIONS

In a region as complex and diverse as the Western Balkans, building trust, creating networks and developing shared visions of the future are not merely aspirational goals. They are key to crafting a common and prosperous future.

Against this backdrop, WBF designed and launched a new open forum for cooperation, the Regional Networking and Dialogue Sessions. It quickly became a successful mechanism of dialogue between institutions, civil society and experts, who mapped current challenges and identified many new cooperation initiatives.

The whole initiative was based on the belief that despite the cultural richness and human potential, yet our societies face shared challenges, educational gaps, fragile cultural networks, economic transitions, climate pressures, and the constant need to strengthen dialogue and reconciliation.

The initiative began in Skopje on November 7, 2024, with the inaugural session focused on education and research. Education is a natural starting point for regional dialogue, it shapes future generations, provides opportunities for cooperation, and equips societies with tools for resilience.

The Skopje event gathered academics, teachers, researchers, and youth organizations to discuss how to strengthen regional academic mobility, research collaboration, and youth exchanges. It was also the official launch of the platform, setting the tone for the entire initiative.

RNDS final session in Prishtina



Key outcomes included:

- Calls for expanding student and researcher mobility across the region.
- Proposals for joint research programs targeting regional challenges such as brain drain and skills mismatch.
- Recognition of education as a foundation for reconciliation and long-term stability.



RNDS session in Skopje

A month later, on December 17, 2024, the second session took place in Belgrade, with cultural cooperation as the central theme. To us, culture has always been one of the most powerful tools for overcoming divisions and it played once more a role of crucial importance.

The Belgrade session gathered artists, cultural managers, NGOs, and policymakers to reflect on how art, heritage, and creative industries can strengthen dialogue.

The session highlighted both opportunities and challenges:

- A need for stronger regional cultural networks that transcend borders.
- Greater investment in creative industries to promote regional talent.
- The role of cultural diplomacy in softening political tensions.

By March 26, 2025, the third stop was Podgorica, where the focus shifted to sustainable development.

This session came at a moment when environmental and developmental concerns have become pressing challenges for the Region, especially in regards to climate change, energy transitions and the need for resilient economies.

Stakeholders in Podgorica engaged in discussions about:

- Strengthening cross-border cooperation on environmental protection.
- Developing joint strategies on renewable energy and green transitions.
- Ensuring that economic development goes hand in hand with social inclusion and environmental sustainability.
- The Podgorica session underscored the fact that sustainable development cannot be achieved in isolation, regional cooperation is not optional, but necessary.

RNDS Session in Belgrade



Regional
Experts 7

100 Regional
stakeholders

Total
Applicants +350

This format was attended by representatives of the governments and EU Delegations in the Region. The Western Balkans Fund selected a wide-range of participants, with the aim to represent as best as possible all the relevant actors of the specific topic. The list of participants and speakers was drafted based on direct invitation or in an open and competitive application process, which generated in overall over 300 applications.

Participants



The final session unfolded in Prishtina from June 11 to 13, 2025, bringing together experts, policymakers, and civil society actors for three consecutive days of dialogue. This was not only a conclusion of the thematic journey but also a celebration of Prishtina's Chairmanship-in-Office of the WBF for 2025.

The Prishtina event consolidated the findings of the previous three sessions. Working groups developed a set of practical recommendations, aimed at shaping the next cycle of regional cooperation. The presence of senior officials, diplomats, and high-level WBF representatives underlined the political importance of the initiative.

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From the presentation of the RND findings held at the final ceremony in Prishtina

What's Next

The Regional Networking and Dialogue Sessions may have concluded in June 2025, but they are part of a much larger process. The Western Balkans Fund and the European Union have laid the groundwork for a more connected, resilient and cooperative region. As the recommendations take shape of concrete actions, the expectation is that these sessions will inspire long-term cooperation, new partnerships and practical projects.

Building capacities and trust

WBF Cooperation with AICS in the framework of “Culture and Creativity for Western Balkans”

In January 2024, the Western Balkans Fund (WBF) received an invitation from the Italian Agency for Development Cooperation (AICS) to submit a proposal for a project titled “Development of Capacity Building Programs for Cultural and Creative Industries in the Western Balkans,” as part of the EU-funded project “Culture and Creativity for the Western Balkans - CC4WBs”.

This initiative was jointly implemented by UNESCO, the British Council, and AICS. The primary aim of this project was to improve the skills of cultural and creative professionals, helping them to increase their fundraising capacities and project management expertise in regional projects.

The agreement between WBF and AICS was formally signed on May 24, 2024, outlining a 12-month collaboration with a total budget of €75,000. The project's activities have been successfully integrated into WBF's annual operations, allowing for effective resource management and coordination.

As part of this initiative, WBF organized 27 capacity-building events. These workshops focused on critical topics such as fundraising methods involving EU programs, WBEDIF, and Creative Europe; project planning, implementation, monitoring, and closure; and promoting community involvement, gender equality, youth engagement, and inclusivity. Events were held across key cities in the region, including Sarajevo, Banja Luka, Prijedor, Mostar, Tuzla in Bosnia and Herzegovina; Shtime, Ferizaj, Prizren, and Prishtina in Kosovo; and Tirana and Korça in Albania.

The events attracted significant interest and effectively engaged



Representatives of MEKI, AICS and stakeholders at a meeting in TUMO, The Pyramid of Tirana

WBF Team presenting in Sarajevo





Workshop in Korça, GAD Gallery

approximately 180 participants from the Cultural and Creative Industries (CCI) sector. Key stakeholders and regional programs such as Creative Europe, IPA Programmes, CC4WB, RYCO, Erasmus+, KIESA, USAID, EBRD, Start Up Albania, Keiretsu Forum for Southeast Europe, and the Innovation and Training Park Prizren participated actively, enhancing the overall impact and promoting cross-sectoral collaboration.

This cooperation has strengthened WBF's operational capabilities and significantly contributed to the sustainable development of CCIs in the Western Balkans, establishing WBF as an influential actor in regional innovation and cooperation.



Workshop held in Prishtina, AAB College

Local leadership, regional impact: The SYNERGYConference Effect

All about the SynergyConference



SYNERGYConference (5th-7th 2025), supported by MOFA Japan, Interantional Visegrad Fund, ReSPAand NALAS brought together central government representativeswith over 60 municipalities across the Western Balkans and Central Europe, alongside key international stakeholders and civil society organizations engagedin local governance. This cooperation enabled knowledge-sharing and empowered local leaders to play a more significant role in shaping the region's future.

Minister Mazniku, at the Opening Ceremony of the Synergy Conference





The Conference was successfully implemented, achieving its overarching goals of networking, knowledge-sharing, and regional cooperation. The event featured a carefully structured agenda that combined interactive panel discussions, keynote

speeches, and networking sessions, ensuring that participants had meaningful opportunities to engage with one another, share expertise, and explore innovative solutions to regional challenges.

A key focus of the conference was to enhance cooperation and knowledge-sharing across sectors. Participants were actively involved in panel discussions and structured networking opportunities, where they engaged in substantive dialogue on issues of shared interest.

The inclusion of high-level decision makers where 9 Ministers were present as speakers, Mayors, experts, policymakers, civil society leaders contributed to a well-rounded discourse, strengthening institutional ties and fostering a culture of regional and international cooperation.

Through these exchanges, participants not only gained valuable insights into policy developments and emerging trends but also identified opportunities for future joint initiatives and collaborations. To sustain the momentum generated during the conference and ensure continuous engagement, WBF implemented a structured follow-up process.



“

EU integration is, in many ways, the untold story of local governance. Municipalities often carry the heavy lifting.

Their role in this process is far from invisible. Municipalities are the bedrock on which successful integration is built, a key part of the big puzzle.

”

Minister of Europe and Foreign Affairs of Republic Albania, H.E Hasani during his speech

H.E. MR. IGLI HASANI
Minister of Europe
and Foreign Affairs
of Albania



Ministers Lipavsky and Hasani congratulate WBF at SYNERGY



“

Tirana is more than just a capital, it is a hub for regional and European cooperation. This conference stands as a testament to Albania's dedication to synergy and integration.

It is inspiring to see mayors from both the Balkans and Central Europe coming together, reflecting the deep connection between our regions. Czechia firmly supports Albania and the Western Balkans on their path to EU membership.”

”

Minister of Foreign Affairs of Czech Republic, H.E Lipavsky during his speech





The background features a light blue gradient with several large, semi-transparent blue spheres and geometric shapes like cubes and pyramids scattered across the left and center. The text is positioned on the left side, overlaid on these shapes.

CHAPTER 4

INSIDE WBF

- Giving voice to large-scale cooperation
- Catalogue of events
- Accountability and Transparency
- WBF Partnership Hub
- Looking forward

3 million+
people reached
on social media

+270%
more LinkedIn
followers

+10%
more Facebook
followers

+30%
more Instagram
followers

+8%
more website
visitors



Making Regional Cooperation Visible

At the WBF, the visibility and impact of our actions is of a crucial importance



Promoting regional cooperation is a crucial component of the Fund's mission. We believe that an enhanced visibility is very important for creating the de-facto solidarity that will support wide-scale cooperation and the reconciliation process in the Western Balkans Area.

As a matter of fact, since the aftermath of the Covid-19 pandemic, consecutive Chairmanship-in-Office of the Fund have turned visibility in a top priority of their agendas.

This emphasis has support a more inclusive, and ever-more present Fund in the Region. In the reporting period of this annual report, we have experienced important growth in all the key visibility parameters. In the social media, our reach has surpassed 3 million, which is an exponential increase compared to around 1.2 million reported in the previous report.

All our channels of communication have experienced growth. As well the presence of the Fund in the regional media. The communication strategy, aligned with the 25-29 Strategic Development Plan is based on five key pillars.

PUBLIC EVENTS

During the reporting period, an unprecedented number of grants resulted in a sharp increase of regional activities. The unprecedented number of Call for Proposals also generated a sharp increase in the Regional Informative Sessions, Fairs or Info Days that the Fund organized in many locations.

Furthermore, new flagship initiative, like the EU co-funded Regional Networking and Dialogue Sessions and the cooperation with the Italian Agency for Development and Cooperation (AICS) in the framework of the "Culture and Creativity for Western Balkans" project, brought the Fund to many new locations in our Region.

Another important type of event has been the participation at the opportunities fairs, most for example the EU projects fair in Belgrade and Tirana. In overall, over 1.000 stakeholders and individuals have been included directly by events organized directly by the Fund, with more in relation to the WBF-supported events.

COMMUNICATION CHANNELS

The reporting period has been remarkable in terms of the growth of our communicating channels. 55.000 individuals have visited our website since last year, an increase from around 48.000 individuals of the previous year. Most of the visitors browsed the different opportunities shared by the Fund, or received different information, such as the one about our success stories, ouretc.

On social media, we continued to grow. The fastest growing channel is our professional channel in LinkedIn, where we share unique information about the job opportunities, our grants or success stories.

In Facebook, Instagram, Threads, Youtube and X channels, where we are also present, we also recorded growth during the reporting period. With over 35 k followers in the social media combined, the Western Balkans Fund ranks on the top list of similar regional organisations and like-minded regional partners.

MAINSTREAM MEDIA

Public events, selected project and success stories have been transmitted in the mainstream media, including regional televisions, news portals, televisions, magazines, radio, etc. Often, the content of the stories is focused around the concrete projects that have been under implementation in a specific region.

Our work was singled out by WeBalkans, the dedicated EU portal. Moreover, the media has been present in the conferences and other events organized directly by the Fund, as well as different initiatives where we have participated as funders or speakers. An important part of this effort, has been also the participation of selected members of the staff at different talk formats or podcasts. Among the media that have shared our content are the national public televisions, Radio Free Europe, N1 Network, Vijesti, etc.



Mr. Bisha, WBFEU Joint Action Manager poses for a picture during the Awarding Ceremony of the Grants

WBF REPRESENTATION AND NETWORKING

The Western Balkans Fund has successfully participated or monitored in field the absolute majority of the grants. There have been over 70 representative or monitoring visits in all over the Region in this reporting cycle. However, this chapter is focused only on the important international events and meetings with institutional stakeholders or like-minded partners.



H.E. Gonzato, Ambassador of the European Delegation to Tirana, during the Awarding Ceremony

PARTNERSHIP PLATFORM

At the Western Balkans Fund, we take pride in being more than a grant-awarding institution. We are also a proactive facilitator of regional partnerships. a role we have embraced with growing determination.

Our WBF Partnership Platform on Facebook, with over 3,500 active members, has already contributed to the formation of hundreds of partnerships, many of which successfully applied for and received WBF grants. This simple, community-driven space has proven that targeted matchmaking across borders is not only possible, it is deeply needed.



1-2-3 presenting the WBFA work at different media platforms

Building on this success, we are now taking steps to develop a dedicated, professional online platform that will further strengthen regional cooperation.

The upcoming platform aims to become a comprehensive partnership hub, serving not only WBFA Calls for Proposals, but also the wider ecosystem of civil society organisations, public institutions, educational entities, and individuals across the Region. As part of this work, WBFA has conducted in-depth research on similar matchmaking platforms — examining both successful models and common pitfalls — in order to define the most suitable design.

Technical consultations, specification drafting, and preliminary negotiations with service providers have also been carried out. Although the platform will not be operational during the two Calls foreseen in Joint Action Phase II, it is expected to be completed and fully functional before the end of the Action.

Once live, it will enable users across the Western Balkans to connect, collaborate, and co-create regional initiatives with greater ease and long-term potential. This new development reaffirms our long-standing belief: cooperation begins with connection — and WBFA remains at the heart of it.



Catalogue of events

Networking, Milestones & Meetings with Partners



Skopje, MEF Forum



Prishtina, Mediawise Conference



Belgrade, EU Fair of Opportunities

June 2024

Skopje, Annual Conference of the Regional Cooperation Council



Tirane, signature of the Memorandum of Cooperation with RAI



September 2024

Tetovo, "Enhancing Public Administration Capabilities" Conference





Prague, Forum 2000 Conference

October 2024

Berlin, Youth Forum 2024



Berlin,
Berlin Process Civil Society
and Think Tank meeting





Begrade, BSC Young Leaders Forum



Belgrade, Belgrade Security Conference



Tirana, Meeting with Minister of Foreign Affairs of Serbia, H.E. Djuric

November 2024

Tirana, Meeting with Minister of Foreign Affairs of North Macedonia, H.E. Mucunski

Tirana, Meeting with Deputy Minister of Foreign Affairs of Bosnia and Herzegovina, H.E. Brkic

Tirana, CEI Ministerial





Tirana, welcoming of RAI delegation

December 2024



Tirana, welcoming of a delegation from
German Ministry of Foreign Affairs

February 2025

Herceg Novi,
“Decent Work Academy”



Tirana, welcoming of delegation from
BSC Young Leaders





Tirana, appreciation reception for the partners of Synergy Conference



Bratislava, 25th anniversary of IVF establishment

March 2025

April 2025

May 2025

June 2025

Tirana, welcoming of the Minister of Europe and Foreign Affairs of Europe, H.E. Hasani

Podgorica, 10th Civil Society Forum

Tirana, South East European Cooperation Process





WBF Team

Accountability and Transparency: WBF operational model

Ensuring responsible financial management, transparency, accountability and sustainability in all the Fund's activities remains a key focus. Throughout the year, the Western Balkans Fund has maintained meticulous financial records in full compliance with internal regulations, consistently upholding the highest standards of integrity. Our commitment to accountability is further demonstrated through the annual audit process, this year conducted in April 2025 by Grant Thornton Albania, one of the top 10 accounting firms in Albania and a member of Grant Thornton International Ltd, one of the world's largest professional services networks of independent accounting.

Below is presented the auditor's opinion:

Independent Auditor's Report

To the Executive Director and Conference of Ministers of Foreign Affairs of Western Balkan Fund,

Opinion

We have audited the accompanying special purpose financial information comprising statement of financial position, the statement of income and expenses, statement of funds, statement of cash flows and the related notes of Western Balkan Fund (further referred to as the "Organization") for the period 1 January 2024 – 31 December 2024.

In our opinion, the special purpose financial information of Western Balkan Fund is prepared, in all material respects, in accordance with the requirements of Modified cash basis of accounting as described in Note 2 of the special purpose financial information.

Basis for opinion

We conducted our audit in accordance with International Standards on Auditing (ISAs). Our responsibilities under those standards are further described in the Auditor's Responsibilities for the audit of the special purpose financial information section of our report. We are independent of the Project in accordance with the International Ethics Standards Board for Accountants' Code of Ethics for Professional Accountants (IESBA Code) together with the ethical requirements that are relevant to our audit of the special purpose financial information in Albania, and we have fulfilled our other ethical responsibilities in accordance with the IESBA Code. We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion.

Emphasis of Matter – Basis of Accounting and Restriction on Distribution

We draw attention to Note 2 to the special purpose financial information, which describes the basis of accounting. The Organization prepares its special purpose financial information on a modified cash basis of accounting. Under this basis, income is recognized when received and expenses are recognized when paid, with limited accrual adjustments. As a result, the recognition of income from contributions and grants may not be presented in a manner proportionate to the related expenses incurred and therefore may not fully reflect the matching principle generally applied in financial reporting frameworks. Our opinion is not modified in respect of this matter.

Responsibilities of Management and Those Charged with Governance for the Special Financial Information

Management is responsible for the preparation and fair presentation of the special purpose financial information in accordance with the basis of accounting described in Note 2 and for such internal control as management determines is necessary to enable the preparation of a special purpose financial information that is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

Management's Responsibility for the special financial information

Management is responsible for the preparation and fair presentation of special purpose financial information. This responsibility includes designing, implementing, and maintaining internal control relevant to the preparation and fair presentation of financial information that is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error; selecting and applying appropriate accounting policies; and making accounting estimates that are reasonable in the circumstances.

Auditor's Responsibilities for the audit of the special financial information

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the special purpose financial information as a whole is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditor's report that includes our opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with ISAs will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of this special purpose financial information.

As part of an audit in accordance with ISAs, we exercise professional judgment and maintain professional skepticism throughout the audit. We also:

- Identify and assess the risks of material misstatement of the special purpose financial information, whether due to fraud or error, design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks, and obtain audit evidence that is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion. The risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from fraud is higher than for one resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal control.
- Obtain an understanding of internal control relevant to the audit in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of the entity's internal control.
- Conclude on the appropriateness of management's use of the going concern basis of accounting and based on the audit evidence obtained, whether a material uncertainty exists related to events or conditions that may cast significant doubt on the entity's ability to continue as a going concern. If we conclude that a material uncertainty exists, we are required to draw attention in our auditor's report to the related disclosures in the special purpose financial information or, if such disclosures are inadequate, to modify our opinion. Our conclusions are based on the audit evidence obtained up to the date of our auditor's report. However, future events or conditions may cause the entity to cease to continue as a going concern.
- Evaluate the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonableness of accounting estimates, if any, and related disclosures made by management.
- Evaluate the overall presentation, structure and content of the special purpose financial information, including the disclosures, and whether the special purpose financial information represents the underlying transactions and events in a manner that achieves fair presentation.

We communicate with those charged with governance regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit and significant audit findings, including any significant deficiencies in internal control that we identify during our audit.

Grant Thornton sh.p.k.

Tirana, Albania

5 May 2025

Grant Thornton sh.p.k.



Statutory Auditor
Ejona Isufi
[Signature]



As part of our continued efforts to strengthen our internal operations, we revised and improved our financial and procurement procedures in September 2024. These updates reflect evolving best practices and are designed to improve clarity, consistency, and oversight across our processes. In addition, we introduced a new Staff Regulation to establish a clearer framework for roles, responsibilities, and organizational conduct, reinforcing transparency and accountability. The implementation of dedicated Human Resources software has enhanced the efficiency, transparency, and traceability of our HR management processes.

July 2025, WBF Retreat.
The Secretariat reviewing (among others),
its financial procedures

Innovation and Digitalisation

WBF working towards a paperless and fully automatised transformation

Year after year, we strive to enhance our systems, making life of the applicants and grantees easier, while improving generally the transparency of our operations. In 2024-25, for the first time, the full grant management system has transitioned to be entirely paperless and online. The entire reporting and management system can be now accessed through our Online Grant Management System, the dedicated portal that we have designed for this purpose.

In the autumn, we will start the work to upgrade and modernize our communication channels.

Among others, the crucial work to modernize our webpage, making it more accessible for all. And last, but not least, we have entered the final stages of designing an online dedicated hub, that will serve as a one-stop-shop for all opportunities and organisations in the Region. This Partnership Hub has been designed with the purpose of facilitating match-making between organisations in different parts of the Region, in order to facilitate their interaction for regional project applications, be it inside the Western Balkans Fund or other important opportunities that might arise.

With Go Easy, based in Kavadarci, currently supporting and enhancing the Online Grant Management System (OGMS)



From the contract signature with Nova Solutions (from Bitola)



Mapping a better future

The Western Balkans Fund has made significant progress in the past seven years, focusing on becoming a reliable partner in the region, implementing lessons learned and strengthening its capacities while envisioning sustainable growth. Looking forward, as we aim to become an even larger organization, we are currently preparing two key documents expected to be adopted in autumn: the Strategic Development Plan 2025-30 and the Fundraising Policies.

The Strategic Development Plan aims to provide a clear roadmap for the future, outlining the organization's priorities and how it intends to achieve them. On the other hand, the Fundraising Policies are designed to enhance the organization's ability to attract and manage funds more effectively, securing its financial health. These policies will build trust among donors and stakeholders through increased transparency and accountability, and pave the way for forming

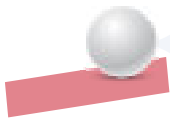
new partnerships and strengthening existing ones. Furthermore, in 2024, for the first time since our establishment, we will run four parallel grant schemes: the ERC Grant Scheme, the Annual Grant Scheme, the WBF Move Grants, and the Western Balkans-Visegrad Fellowship.

The diversification process started back in 2020-21 is yielding clear results, and we aim to increase it further. Simultaneously, the Fund will invest in perfecting its Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning instruments, its regional presence, and our internal capabilities. We will continue to seek to attract the best talent available, convinced of the amazing capabilities of the people of this region. Finally, our partners remain our biggest asset. The following months will be crucial to further consolidate our growing pool of donors and like-minded partners.



DIVERSIFICATION
NEW PARTNERSHIPS
LARGER GRANT SCHEME
RAPID GROWTH

Discover what lies ahead in
the near future of the Fund!



Agile and inclusive grant-making

will remain central to WBF's mission but will evolve to become more agile, responsive, and inclusive. The Fund will streamline procedures and develop customized compliance frameworks to better serve grassroots organizations, especially those with limited administrative capacity. A more diversified grant portfolio will ensure broader access and increased outreach across the region.



Expanded capacity development

will be significantly scaled up and tailored to meet the distinct development stages of grantees. Moving beyond traditional trainings in compliance, PCM, and reporting, WBF will offer comprehensive organizational development support in partnership with specialized actors, fostering long-term sustainability among beneficiaries.



Strategic engagement & visibility

the Fund will invest in strategic advocacy, structured dialogue, and knowledge exchange to enhance its regional visibility and policy impact. These efforts will strengthen WBF's role as a regional platform for trust-building, innovation, and people-to-people cooperation.

Through this forward-looking strategic plan, WBF reaffirms its commitment to deepening regional ties and empowering civil society as a driving force for integration, stability, and progress across the Western Balkans.

Annual Reports



Annual reports of the Western Balkans Fund can be always read & downloaded at <https://westernbalkansfund.org/wbf-documents/> or scan the QR code





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